



'Will bring laws against love, land jihad in 6 months'

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvenudh Adhikari on Sunday said his government will bring stringent laws against "love jihad" and "land jihad" in six months, and implement a Uniform Civil Code in the state like Uttarakhand and Gujarat.

P10

Justice must not only be done but also remain beyond doubt

When a retired Supreme Court judge joins the governing body of a Reliance-backed wildlife initiative, a legitimate question arises. It is not whether he did anything wrong. It is whether the institution he served can still persuade citizens that nothing was wrong.

P6

Asset allocation is the foundation of a portfolio

When planning to build a portfolio, the usual questions include which assets to pick, which mutual funds (MF) to add and what about gold allocation, etc. But the portfolio construction begins somewhere else. A good portfolio isn't about a collection of good investments.

P11

Sharwa's 'Bhogi' teaser generates immense hype

The first look poster and teaser of 'Bhogi', featuring Charming Star Sharwa, created an exponential buzz for the upcoming film. The action-pacy drama is directed by Sampath Nandi. For this film, a massive transformation was required.

P12

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WINDOWS

Nepal-bound flydubai flight diverted to Lko

DUBAI: A flydubai flight from Dubai to Nepal's Pokhara was diverted to Lucknow on Saturday evening due to adverse weather at the destination airport, officials said. Flight FZ 1165, operating from Dubai International Airport to Pokhara, was diverted to Lucknow's Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport, landing safely at 6:53 pm, they said. The flight was operated by a Boeing 737 MAX 8 aircraft with registration A6-FMU. After weather conditions at the Pokhara airport improved, the aircraft departed from Lucknow at 8.08 pm, officials said. The diversion was solely due to bad weather and was not prompted by any technical problem or emergency. The aircraft made a normal landing at Lucknow airport, they said.

Army personnel held with banned drugs at airport

JAMMU: Security forces arrested an army personnel at the drop gate of Srinagar International Airport after recovering contraband substance from his baggage, officials said on Sunday. Police and CRPF personnel apprehended the army personnel on Saturday after recovering poppy straw and a cannabis-like substance from his possession, the officials said. The banned substances recovered included 213 grams of poppy straw and 69 grams of a cannabis-like substance. A case has been registered under relevant sections of the law, and an investigation has been set in motion, they added.

Army soldier found hanging inside camp in Jammu

JAMMU: A 45-year-old soldier allegedly died by suicide after hanging himself in an army camp here on Sunday, officials said. Naik Wagh Ambades, a resident of Maharashtra, was found hanging in a shed at Sunjwan camp in Channi Himmat area, they said. Officials said the body was shifted to Government Medical College Hospital for postmortem and other legal formalities. The motive behind the alleged suicide was not immediately known, they said, adding that police have started inquest proceedings in connection with the incident.

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Improve law and order. People should think a thousand times before stepping out to protest

3 women journalists allege sexual abuse by cops

HANS NEWS SERVICE
NEW DELHI

THREE women journalists have alleged sexual harassment by police personnel during a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar in Jantar Mantar on October 3, prompting the Delhi Police to transfer their complaints to the Crime Branch for an impartial enquiry, an officer said on Sunday.

One of the women journalists told PTI that an Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) sexually

assaulted her. The officer said the New Delhi district police received the complaints following the alleged incidents during the protest, when police personnel were deployed to maintain law and order. The district police have transferred the complaints to the Crime Branch for a fair and impartial enquiry, the officer said.

The Crime Branch will examine the allegations and record statements from the complainants and other persons concerned as part of the enquiry, the officer said. The women journalist

told PTI that she and others subsequently went to a police station to lodge an FIR, but alleged that no action had been taken.

"Police personnel were detaining protesters, and no women police personnel were present at the spot. I asked ACP Vivek Bhagat of the Delhi Police about the absence of women police personnel, following which he sexually assaulted me and pushed me back," she alleged.

However, ACP Vivek Bhagat could not be contacted despite repeated calls and messages. A

● One of the women journalists said that an ACP sexually assaulted her. Vivek Bhagat could not be contacted despite repeated calls and messages. His name was mentioned in the complaint

● The Press Council of India expressed shock and dismay over the police's treatment of journalists covering the protest and urged the Delhi Police to act on the complaint immediately

source said his name was mentioned in the complaint submitted by the journalists.

The Press Council of India expressed "shock and dismay" over the police's treatment of journalists covering the protest and

urged the Delhi Police to act on the complaint immediately.

"Behaviour of this kind cannot be normalised in a democracy. Journalists must be allowed to work freely, without fear, and document those who



gather to raise various issues. That this is not being allowed even at the heart of the national capital does not bode well for the trajectory of media freedom in India," it said in a statement.

"The Delhi Police must immediately act on the female journalist's complaint and ensure that it gives media persons the space to do their jobs without facing aggression and threats," it added.

2006 KSTP project scam; death of engineer

Keralam HM orders probe against CEC Gyanesh

State Home Minister Chennithala ordered the probe after KPCC leader Malayinkeezhu Venugopal filed a complaint seeking an investigation; UDF, LDF welcome Vigilance probe

HANS NEWS SERVICE
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

KERALAM Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala has ordered a Vigilance probe into the corruption allegations in the KSTP road work project and the death of a Malaysian engineer associated with it in 2006, when incumbent CEC Gyanesh Kumar was serving as the PWD secretary in the state, sources said on Sunday.

The development comes amid protests by the Congress and other opposition parties against



Gyanesh Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls across India. Gyanesh Kumar is a Kerala-cadre IAS officer who headed various departments in the state before moving to central ministries.

Chennithala ordered the probe after KPCC leader Malayinkeezhu Venugopal filed a complaint seeking an investigation against Gyanesh Kumar. Speaking to reporters, Chennithala said he examined the complaint and found prima facie merit in the allegations.

The ruling UDF and Opposition LDF welcomed Chennithala's decision to order a Vigilance probe.

"I am convinced that a detailed Vigilance inquiry is essential," he said, adding that he has spoken to Chief Minister V D Satheesan before directing Vigilance Director Manoj Abraham to take lawful steps to conduct a detailed investigation. In 2006, a World Bank-funded project worth Rs 215 crore was undertaken by the Kerala State Transport

Project (KSTP) for the reconstruction of the MC Road from Angamaly to Thiruvananthapuram. He said PATI-BEL, a joint venture between the Malaysian firm and Bhageeratha Engineering, had undertaken the project. A Malaysian company undertook the work, while its project engineer, Lee See Been, allegedly raised several complaints during the construction and later returned to Malaysia, where he died by suicide. Chennithala said two suicide notes were reportedly recovered, one addressed to the engineer's wife and another to the director of the company, in which Gyanesh Kumar was explicitly mentioned. The minister said after the incident, Vigilance had examined the matter, including the contents of the note written in Kuala Lumpur, but the investigation did not progress after the government changed in 2006.

Gyanesh is BJP's weapon: Uddhav; cancel SIR: Raj

HANS NEWS SERVICE
MUMBAI

SHIV Sena-UBT head Uddhav Thackeray on Sunday alleged that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar was the "weapon" of the ruling BJP, while MNS leader Raj Thackeray demanded cancellation of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls in Maharashtra. The Thackeray cousins led a protest march in Mumbai against the CEC, culminating in a rally.



The Maharashtra Navnirman Sena chief demanded that future polls in the country should be conducted through paper ballot.

He also demanded cancellation of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Maharashtra. "If the SIR was conducted

to weed out Bangladeshis from the voters' list, then how many Bangladeshis residing illegally in the country did the government find?" Uddhav Thackeray asked. "Gyanesh Kumar is a weapon of the BJP," he alleged.

State leaders of Congress and the Sharad Pawar-led NCP-SP also participated in the morchha, which began at Metro Cinema and traversed the short distance to the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation headquarters in south Mumbai.

Netanyahu invites Smit, PM Modi to I-Day event

DUBAI: Israel's Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu spoke with Indian pilot Smit Machchhar, calling him a "hero" of the entire world for foiling an alleged attempt by his co-pilot to crash an Israel-bound flydubai flight.

Netanyahu spoke to the pilot, who is currently undergoing treatment at a hospital in the UAE, and also invited Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Machchhar to light a flame on Israeli Independence Day.

Navy sailor held for leaking data to female Pak operative

HANS NEWS SERVICE
COIMBATORE

AN Indian Navy sailor accused of 'transmitting' classified maritime intelligence to a Pakistani operative was arrested, officials said on Sunday.

According to official sources, the espionage operation involved a social media 'honey-trap'.

The Andhra Pradesh Police Counter Intelligence (CI) cell arrested 31-year-old Pradeep Mukherjee on October 3 at INS Agrani, a naval leadership training facility in Coimbatore.



Mukherjee, a West Bengal native who joined the Navy in 2014, was actively posted with the Eastern Naval Command in Visakhapatnam.

At the time of his arrest, he was attending a management development course and had been at the Coimbatore facility for approximately one week. A female Pakistani

intelligence operative reportedly contacted Mukherjee several months ago. Over time, the handler leveraged the online relationship to extract sensitive data regarding strategic naval assets, fleet movements, and the operational framework of the Visakhapatnam base.

The CI cell, a specialised unit tasked with countering cross-border espionage and terror threats, initiated the investigation after detecting suspicious digital footprints linked to the sailor, subsequently placing him under surveillance.

Woman forced to deliver baby out in open in UP

HANS NEWS SERVICE
RAEBARELI

A woman was forced to deliver a baby outside the Raebareli district hospital here after she was allegedly denied admission by the staff, a relative has claimed.

The claim was made in a video circulating on social media on Sunday.

In the video, Archana, a relative of the woman, claimed that she had brought her sister-in-law to the hospital after she developed labour pain on Saturday.

She alleged that hospital staff initially asked the woman to keep walking, took her to



a labour room several times, without formally admitting her, and sent her back without delivery. Archana alleged that a hospital staffer demanded Rs 10,000 for the delivery and told them not to disclose the matter to anyone. While all this happened, the woman delivered a baby outside the hospital. District Women's Hospital superintendent Nirmala Sahu denied the allegation that the hospital staff demanded money.



Pink Saheli Card mandatory for free bus travel by women

HANS NEWS SERVICE
NEW DELHI

THE Delhi government has notified that women residents can avail free travel on DTC and cluster buses only through the 'Pink Saheli Smart Card', officials said on Sunday.

The change was made under the Delhi Transport Corporation (Free and Concessional Passes) (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026.

19 lakh women have availed themselves of the smart-card facility since its launch earlier this year. Women who have not yet registered will continue to have access to the registration and card issuance process

"Female passengers who are residents of Delhi



can travel free in Delhi Transport Corporation

(DTC) and cluster buses, both AC and non-AC, only

with the Pink Saheli Smart Card (NCMC). However, they will have the option to purchase a ticket at the applicable fare for the journey," a Delhi Transport Department notification said.

Women ineligible for the free travel facility can also travel on DTC and cluster buses by purchasing tickets at the applicable fare, it said. The provisions will also apply to transgender persons who are residents

of Delhi, the notification added. Launched in March this year, the NCMC-based card replaced the paper-based pink tickets earlier issued by the government after several extensions.

The Transport Department had earlier directed that the Pink Saheli Smart Card would be mandatory for availing the free travel facility from September 30.

Officials said the government will focus

on creating awareness about the smart card through depot and in-bus announcements, social media, print media and other channels.

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VIJAY TAKES OUT ROADSHOW IN DHARAPURAM

‘Attacking women crosses the line, won’t remain silent’

DHARAPURAM (TN)

LASHING out against escalating personal attacks and “crude rhetoric in the state’s political discourse”, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Sunday issued a “stern warning” to opposition parties against targeting women.

The TVK founder said that attacking women has crossed the line and that he won’t remain silent. He made the remarks during roadshow in bypoll bound Dharapuram in Tiruppur district and alleged DMK leaders were attacking women.

Pointing to recent political speeches targeting women leaders, he said, “I told you earlier if you vote for the DMK and certain others, it amounts to endorsing those who speak obscenely about



Slams DMK for remarks against women

women and humiliate them in public spaces. I didn’t say that just to score political points. Look at what happened the day before yesterday”. He was referring to certain alleged controversial remarks by DMK president M K Stalin against TVK’s Dharapuram bypoll candi-

date P Satyabama. Vijay and his party leaders have described Stalin’s criticism as amounting to “body-shaming” the woman candidate. “What kind of vile speech did he (Stalin) make against our sister, Sathyabama. It was so vulgar that one cannot even bear to listen to it. And

is he the only one speaking like this. Every single person he has nurtured and brought up is delivering the exact same cheap rhetoric.”

“Speak whatever you want about me. I will take it. But if you dare speak against our sister, or against the mothers, sisters, and daughters of our households, I will not stay quiet. This marks a return to the era of MGR,” he said referring to late CM and AIADMK founder M G Ramachandran.

At Dharapuram, Vijay started the roadshow on his preferred customised caravan around 1 pm and was expected to cover a 40-km stretch before campaign ends for the October 6 bypolls at 6 pm on Sunday.

During his roadshow, the TN CM also interacted with the voters. He also took a

bullock cart ride for a short distance. He also received several gifts, flowers, garlands and party towels during the road show. On the way, he offered prayers at Moolanur Vanchiamman shrine, where he was accorded traditional temple honours.

At many places, people showered flower petals on him. The planned campaign route is expected to cover more than 20 public-contact points over 40 km in the Dharapuram area.

The campaign procession will pass through key stretches, including the Periyar statue junction, five roads junction, and Meenakshipuram, Kulathupalayam, Karaiyur and so on.

This was Vijay’s second campaign visit to the constituency, following his September 30 rally.

Indian Navy sailor held for leaking classified data to Pak operative



COIMBATORE (TN)

AN Indian Navy sailor accused of “transmitting” classified maritime intelligence to a Pakistani operative was arrested, officials said on Sunday. According to official sources, the espionage operation involved a social media “honey-trap”. The Andhra Pradesh Police Counter Intelligence (CI) cell arrested 31-year-old Pradeep Mukherjee on October 3 at INS Agrani, a naval leadership training facility in Coimbatore.

Mukherjee, a West Bengal native who joined the Navy in 2014, was actively posted with the Eastern Naval Command in Visakhapatnam. At the time of his arrest, he

was attending a management development course and had been at the Coimbatore facility for approximately one week.

A female Pakistani intelligence operative reportedly contacted Mukherjee several months ago. Over time, the handler leveraged the online relationship to extract sensitive data regarding strategic naval assets, fleet movements, and the operational framework of the Visakhapatnam base.

The CI cell, a specialised unit tasked with countering cross-border espionage and terror threats, initiated the investigation after detecting suspicious digital footprints linked to the sailor, subsequently placing him under surveillance.

TN bypolls - Dharapuram campaign

FIR against Udhayanidhi for involving child in campaign

TIRUPPUR

TIRUPPUR district police have registered a case against Tamil Nadu Leader of Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin for allegedly involving a child in an election campaign and making the child speak in a manner insulting to the Chief Minister.

The incident allegedly took place during a campaign meeting near the Periyar statue in Dharapuram town on Saturday, according to a press release issued by police.

Police said the case has been registered at the Dharapuram Police Station and that an investigation was underway.

The press release did not specify the legal provisions under which Udhayanidhi had been booked.

The police action comes while the Model Code of Conduct is in force in the Dharapuram Assembly constituency. The district police referred to the Election Commission’s instructions



against involving children in election-related activities.

According to the release, the Commission had directed that children should not be used for any activity connected with elections. Police cited these instructions while outlining the allegations relating to Saturday’s campaign meeting.

Police registered a case alleging that Udhayanidhi made a child speak in a manner insulting the Tamil Nadu Chief Minister and used children for election campaigning.

The police release did not identify the child, disclose the complainant, provide details of the alleged remarks, or establish the allegations, which remain under investigation.

Further details about the case, including the provisions invoked and the evidence being examined, were not provided. The district police said the Dharapuram Police Station was continuing its investigation into the alleged use of children during the election campaign meeting.



CHENNAI

Legendary filmmaker Singeetham no more

LEGENDARY filmmaker Singeetham Srinivasa Rao died at a private hospital here due to ill health, family sources said. Rao breathed his last at the Kauvery hospital on Saturday night, they said adding he was 95.

The veteran director leaves behind a massive legacy in Indian cinema. His mortal remains have been kept for public homage at his residence in Virugambakkam.

The final rites are scheduled to be held this afternoon at around 2pm at the Nesapakkam crematorium in Chennai. Rao was celebrated for his creative genius and helmed several iconic films, including ‘Raja Paarvai’, ‘Little John’, Kamal Haasan-

starrer ‘Apoorva Sagodharagal’, ‘Michael Madana Kama Rajan’, and ‘Kadhala Kadhala’. His directorial brilliance earned him a National Award for the film ‘Dikkatra Parvathi’. Undeterred by age, he remained active in the industry and released his final film, titled ‘Sing Geetham’, earlier this year.

The Indian film fraternity expressed deep sorrow over his demise. Telugu Filmmaker Srinu Vaitla mourned the loss, praising Rao’s imagination, innovation, and passion for storytelling that resulted in a timeless body of work.

Taking to X, lyricist Vairamuthu paid his respects, stating that the late director’s artistic achievements will continue to keep his memory alive.

Hydroponic ganja worth Rs 5.2 cr seized at Chennai airport

CHENNAI

HYDROPONIC ganja worth Rs 5.2 crore was seized from a passenger at the Chennai International Airport here, the Customs department said on Sunday.

Based on passenger profiling, officers of the Air Intelligence Unit (AIU), Chennai Customs intercepted a male passenger, who had arrived at the airport from Bangkok on October 2, K M Guru Rajesh, Joint Commissioner of Customs, Chennai International Airport here said in a release.

Accordingly, the passenger attempted to exit through the Green Channel without making any declaration to Customs.

Upon detailed examination of his checked-in baggage, 26 transparent airtight packets containing dried greenish-brown flowering and fruiting tops of a plant, suspected to be



high-grade hydroponically cultivated Cannabis (Ganja), were recovered.

The packets were ingeniously concealed inside Thai food packets. The recovered contraband weighed 15.02 kilograms and tested positive for Ganja/Marijuana using the Narcotic Drug Detection Kit (NDDK).

The contraband was seized under the provisions of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act. The seized

drug worth approximately Rs.5.26 Crores in the illicit market.

The passenger has been arrested under the relevant provisions of the NDPS Act and remanded to judicial custody. Further investigation is in progress.

Chennai Customs also advised the public, particularly the youth, to remain vigilant against offers of sponsored foreign travel and easy money for carrying unknown baggage on their return journey.

Anamalayar-Nallaru project

TN ministerial team to visit Kerala for talks today

CHENNAI

A delegation of Tamil Nadu ministers is expected to travel to Kerala on Monday to continue discussions on the Anamalayar-Nallaru project, a longstanding demand of farmers seeking improved irrigation facilities in Coimbatore, Tiruppur and Erode districts.

According to reports, the delegation will comprise state Water Resources Minister Anand, Revenue Minister Sengottaiyan, Public Welfare Minister Arunraj and Tourism Minister Rajesh Kumar.

The ministers are expected to meet Kerala Chief Minister V D Satheesan and the state’s Irrigation Minister to discuss the proposed project and its implementation.

The visit, scheduled for October 5, is intended to carry forward discussions between the two states. However, the report does not specify the meeting venue, the detailed agenda or whether any formal agreement is expected during the talks.

Farmers in the three western Tamil Nadu districts have long sought implementation of the Anamalayar-Nallaru project to strengthen irrigation facilities. Their demand forms the central backdrop to the proposed ministerial visit, which will bring the issue before Kerala’s political leadership.

The delegation’s discussions are expected to focus on the project’s implementation. The available information does not indicate whether the ministers will present a revised proposal, seek specific clearances or discuss a timetable for further negotiations.

With the Water Resources Minister forming part of the delegation, the proposed meeting will provide an opportunity for direct discussions on the irrigation initiative. The participation of three other ministers also places the



visit within a broader ministerial engagement between Tamil Nadu and Kerala.

For farmers awaiting progress, the immediate significance of the visit lies in the continuation of discussions on a demand that has remained pending for years.

The outcome will depend on what the two sides agree to take forward after their meeting. No details have been provided on the project’s estimated cost, funding arrangements, construction schedule or the envisaged irrigation coverage.

The report also does not mention any decision already reached between the two governments on these aspects. The planned visit, therefore, represents another round of discussions on the proposal.

Whether it produces a concrete decision, a further meeting or additional examination of the project will become clear only after the talks. The focus now turns to Monday’s expected meeting with CM Satheesan and the Irrigation Minister, as Tamil Nadu seeks to advance discussions on the farmers’ longstanding irrigation demand.

TN bypolls: Left parties turn to social media to reach voters

CHENNAI

CANDIDATE-focused social media pages, WhatsApp groups, and dedicated channels are shaping the Left parties’ outreach in Tamil Nadu’s Madurantakam and Dharapuram, where the CPI and CPI(M) are using digital platforms to connect with voters ahead of the Assembly bypolls.

Having largely contested elections within alliances, the parties are drawing on their cadre networks to circulate campaign updates, present their candidates’ views and bring attention to local issues flagged by voters.

Party functionaries said workers and supporters are sharing the material voluntarily through WhatsApp, Facebook and Instagram. The campaigns do not involve paid promotions or bulk SMS messaging, they added.

The CPI(M)’s Madurantakam campaign alone has established over 100 WhatsApp groups. S. Kannan, the party’s campaign in-charge, said each brings together roughly 300 party members and 300-500 voters drawn from the locality concerned. The groups provide an avenue for circulating campaign messages among voters while helping party workers coordinate their activities across



different parts of the constituency.

The CPI(M) has also established a dedicated WhatsApp channel and separate Facebook and Instagram pages for the bypoll, said Suthir, the party’s state social media in-charge. Its social media pages carry the title “Vote for Suganthi”, placing the Madurantakam candidate at the centre of the party’s online campaign.

The platforms are being used to share her positions and the party’s views on public issues. To connect its printed publicity material with its digital campaign, the CPI(M) has included QR codes on pamphlets distributed to voters. Scanning the codes enables residents to follow campaign updates and access the party’s views through its online platforms.

In Dharapuram, the CPI has organised its digital outreach by dividing the consti-

tuency into three parts. It has created a WhatsApp channel for each section under the title “Dharapuram Idathu Pakkam”, which party members translate as “Dharapuram is for the Left”.

Around 100 WhatsApp groups have also been formed in the constituency, giving the party an additional network for distributing messages and coordinating campaign work. Across both constituencies, the approach combines party organisation with digital communication. Cadres circulate material through groups, while dedicated channels and social media pages allow voters to follow the campaign.

The two parties are extending their outreach through platforms already used by voters, with supporters carrying their messages into networks as campaigning continues in Madurantakam and Dharapuram.

Former AIADMK MLA Murugumaran joins TVK

TIRUPPUR

FORMER legislator and AIADMK organising secretary N. Murugumaran joined the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) in Dharapuram on Sunday after resigning from the opposition party, accusing its leadership of sidelining committed workers and favouring wealthy candidates.

Murugumaran, who represented Kattumannarkoil in the Assembly twice, met TVK general secretary and Rural Development and Water Resources Minister N. Anand before joining the party.

His departure adds to the defections of former ministers and party functionaries following the AIADMK’s defeat in the Assembly election.

Announcing his resignation earlier in the day, Murugumaran said he remained dissatisfied over the denial of an opportunity to contest from his former constituency in the 2026 election.

He alleged that the leadership had encouraged him to work extensively in Kattumannarkoil but subsequently fielded him elsewhere. Murugumaran won the Kattumannarkoil seat on an AIADMK ticket in 2011 and 2016.

Although he sought to return to the constituency this year, the party nominated him from the reserved Tittakudi constituency. He



secured 42,502 votes in Tittakudi, finishing behind DMK candidate C.V. Ganesan, who won with 63,106 votes, and TVK candidate Rajasekhar, who polled 60,477 votes to take second place.

In his resignation statement, Murugumaran accused the AIADMK leadership of giving preference to candidates with substantial financial resources while overlooking those who had worked sincerely for the organisation.

He claimed that ordinary workers, people from poorer backgrounds and those without crores of rupees were increasingly unable to secure political opportunities within the party. Such an approach, he argued, was pushing the AIADMK towards becoming the third force in Tamil Nadu politics.

Murugumaran also alleged that he had not been given due importance in Kattumannarkoil during the party’s campaign programme centred on its pledge to “save Tamil Nadu” in 2026.

MP Chowta calls for High Court bench in Mangaluru

HANS NEWS SERVICE
MANGALURU

DAKSHINA Kannada MP Captain Brijesh Chowta said that a High Court bench must be established in Mangaluru, now growing as a major city of the state after Bengaluru, and that the city will gain further weight from it.

He spoke on Saturday at a consultation held in a private hotel in Mangaluru, after a judges' committee was constituted to look into the possibility of a High Court bench. He said that the fight should become a public demand rather than remain confined to advocates.

"The way justice was secured when Mangaluru's railway region was attached from Palakkad to the Mysuru division, the High Court bench demand for Mangaluru should likewise be fulfilled. Collection of views at taluk level is also required to support it," he said.



Speakers included MLA Vedavyas Kamath, former Rajya Sabha member B Ibrahim, former minister B Nagaraj Shetty, former Legislative Council member Monappa Bhandary, advocates' association president

Jagadish Shenava, struggle committee PRO M P Noronha and former advocates' association president H V Raghavendra.

Lawyers and prominent figures from various associations participated. Sridhar Shetty gave the vote of thanks. Jagadish K R managed the programme.

Congress names 25 MLAs for corporation, board posts

HANS NEWS SERVICE
BENGALURU

THE Congress has finalised the names of 25 MLAs for appointment as chairpersons of major corporations and boards in Karnataka and is awaiting the Election Commission's approval in view of the model code of conduct for the Legislative Council elections.

Official orders are expected to be issued once the Election Commission gives its consent. After the appointment orders for the MLAs are issued, the party is likely to nominate senior leaders to other corporation and board positions. The appointments are expected to be taken up largely after the restructuring of the Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee



(KPCC). With a series of elections, including Zilla Panchayat and Taluk Panchayat polls, expected ahead, the Congress is also undertaking an organisational revamp. Along with changes in office-bearers and the formation of a new executive

committee, the process of setting up a Political Affairs Committee to improve coordination between the party and the government has also begun. There is growing pressure within the ruling party for the Political Affairs Committee to

be formed so that major policy decisions can be discussed on the party platform in advance. The move is aimed at ensuring that government decisions remain aligned with the party's stated positions and preventing unilateral decisions.

Former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and KPCC president B K Hariprasad are learnt to have pressed for the committee to be formed at the earliest. Deputy Chief Minister G Parameshwara, who met Rahul Gandhi in Delhi recently, has also reportedly raised the issue with the party leadership.

The committee is being planned along the lines of similar panels in Congress-ruled states. A 10-member Group of Ministers has already been formed at the government

level, while a Political Affairs Committee comprising representatives of both the party and government is expected to be constituted soon.

Chief Minister D K Shivakumar is scheduled to travel to Delhi on October 6 for a two-day visit, during which he will attend a GST meeting and meet senior AICC leaders. A decision on the committee's formation is expected during the visit, party sources said.

The KPCC is also preparing to constitute an executive committee of around 25 to 30 members, along with changes in office-bearers and appointments to various frontal organisations. The restructuring is expected to continue as the party prepares for upcoming local-body elections.

Narayanaswamy challenges Cong over 'vote theft' claims

'If vote theft happened in Karnataka and Kerala, make your governments resign'

HANS NEWS SERVICE
BENGALURU

KARNATAKA Legislative Council Opposition Leader Chalavadi Narayanaswamy challenged the Congress to seek the resignation of its governments if it believes that "vote theft" occurred in Karnataka and Kerala during elections.

Speaking to reporters in Bengaluru, Narayanaswamy was reacting to Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's reported letter to the Election Commission seeking cancellation of elections held after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) and demanding a return to ballot paper voting.

He said political demands should have a logical basis.



"If vote theft has happened in Karnataka and Kerala, the Congress has governments in both states. Let them resign and show us," he said. Narayanaswamy defended the SIR exercise, saying it was being conducted according to constitutional provisions. He claimed that similar electoral roll revision exercises had

also been conducted when the Congress was in power and questioned the need for the party to oppose the present exercise.

He alleged that the Congress was opposing SIR as part of a political strategy and said Form 7 applications were meant to remove names of deceased persons, duplicate vot-

ers and ineligible voters from electoral rolls. He rejected allegations that Form 7 applications were being printed or misused by the BJP, saying copies were available on the Election Commission's website. Narayanaswamy said the BJP would approach the Election Commission with a complaint against the Congress' allegations. He also disputed claims that 40-50 lakh voters had already been deleted from the electoral rolls, saying no names had so far been removed through Form 7 applications.

He challenged the Congress to provide documentary evidence for its allegations and warned that the BJP would launch protests if its workers were targeted.

JDS questions Rs 200 Cr Bengaluru Jatre spending

HANS NEWS SERVICE
BENGALURU

THE Janata Dal (Secular) has launched a sharp attack on the Karnataka government over the proposed Bengaluru Jatre, questioning the decision to spend a reported Rs 200 crore on the 10-day event amid problems faced by the city and farmers.

The criticism came soon after Bengaluru Urban Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda announced that Bengaluru Jatre would be held from December 4 to 13. Taking to X, the JDS accused the Congress government of focusing on celebrations while failing to address basic civic and infrastructure issues.

The party compared the government's approach to the story of Roman emperor Nero playing the fiddle while



Rome burned. It alleged that the government had already spent hundreds of crores on its 100-day programme and was now preparing to spend more money in the name of Bengaluru Jatre.

"Who asked you to spend Rs 200 crore on Bengaluru Jatre?" the JDS asked, questioning the priority given to the event. The party highlighted Bengaluru's pothole-ridden roads and traffic

congestion, sarcastically referring to the daily difficulties faced by motorists. It alleged that the government had failed to provide adequate roads, water, electricity and other essential infrastructure.

The JDS further claimed that funds from agencies such as the Bangalore Development Authority, Bangalore Electricity Supply Company, Bangalore Water Supply and

Sewerage Board and Bengaluru Metro could be diverted for the proposed celebrations. The opposition party also raised concerns over the plight of farmers, claiming that inadequate rainfall and crop losses had pushed many farmers into debt and distress.

"Only when farmers have food on their plates can the state celebrate art, literature, festivals and fairs," the JDS said. The party demanded that the government abandon what it described as an extravagant celebration and instead divert the entire proposed expenditure towards helping distressed farmers.

The JDS said the government should prioritise basic infrastructure and farmers' welfare, arguing that celebrations could be held only when people's fundamental needs were addressed.

Education system must adapt to changes: Prof. Sadagopan

HANS NEWS SERVICE
BENGALURU

"IN the present situation where technology and artificial intelligence are developing rapidly, the education system must also adapt to new changes," said Prof. S Sadagopan, Founder Director of the International Institute of Information Technology Bangalore (IIIT-B).

Speaking after conferring degrees on students at the convocation ceremony organised by BMS College of Engineering (BMSCE), Basavanagudi, he said, "Artificial intelligence will bring significant changes in the fields of education and employment in the coming days. However, AI cannot completely replace human intelligence. Creativity, critical thinking and human values will always remain important."

"Educational institutions



should provide greater encouragement to research, entrepreneurship and innovation. It is the responsibility of the youth to contribute to the development of the country by using technology for the betterment of society," he said.

BMSCE Principal Dr Bheemsha Arya, speaking on the occasion, said, "Your knowledge will increase your self-confidence. Good behaviour will earn you respect. The contribution you make to society will bring meaning

to your life. You are stepping into a competitive era. There will be both success and failure. May God bless you with the strength to face everything courageously," he wished the students.

A total of 1,822 students were awarded engineering degrees on the occasion.

BMSCE Governing Council Chairman Aviram Sharma, Vice-Principal Dr D Sheshalchalam, Dean Dr Jyothi S Nayak and others were present.

Leaders felicitate Asian Games gold medallist Poovamma

HANS NEWS SERVICE
MANGALURU

LOCAL leaders visited the residence of M R Poovamma, the coastal athlete who won gold for India in the 4x400m relay at the Asian Games in Nagoya, Japan, taking the coastal region's name to the international stage. They congratulated her on her achievement.

Mangaluru City South BJP MLA Vedavyas Kamath said medal winners at the Asian Games had received cash rewards and encouragement in other states and urged the state government to extend similar recognition to Kudla's golden girl. He also called for Poovamma to be appointed to a senior post under the sports quota. He expressed hope that she would achieve greater success in the years ahead and inspire young people through her accomplishments.

Dakshina Kannada MP Captain Brijesh Chowta also felicitated Poovamma. He said her strength, stride and spirit had brought global glory to India and kept the national flag flying high at the Asian Games. He described his visit



to her residence as a moment of immense pride and said her journey should inspire young athletes to dream big, push their limits and strive for excellence.

Separately, district in-charge minister U T Khader, representing the district administration, felicitated Poovamma at her residence. District Commissioner Darshan H V, Zilla Panchayat Chief Executive Officer Vinayak Narwade Karbari, MUDA president Santosh Kumar Shetty, coach Dinesh Kunder, district Congress president Padmaraj R Pojary, Youth Empowerment and Sports Department deputy director Pradeep D'Souza, Kanachuru Monu, and Poovamma's parents and family members were present.

KSTDC plans 'Mayura Ruchi on Wheels' from November



HANS NEWS SERVICE
BENGALURU

TOURISTS visiting major destinations across Karnataka will soon have access to clean and quality food at affordable prices, with the Karnataka State Tourism Development Corporation (KSTDC) set to introduce a mobile food truck initiative called 'Mayura Ruchi on Wheels'.

The project was approved at a board meeting held on Saturday under the chairmanship of Minister K.J. George. The tender process will begin on October 5, with KSTDC aiming to launch the food trucks by the third week of November, a KSTDC official said.

"Operators with extensive experience in the sector will be selected to run specially designed vehicles equipped with live kitchens. The objective is to provide quick service while ensuring that food is not wasted. Operators will also partner with restaurants around tourist destinations for sourcing the required ingredients," the official said.

Each food truck is expected to cost around Rs 30 lakh. KSTDC will operate one food truck at each selected tourist destination. The pilot project will be launched in Hampi, Nandi Hills, Bengaluru and Mysuru, and will later be expanded to Madikeri and Jog Falls.

The food trucks will offer sandwiches, fries, burgers, pizza and ice cream, along

with South Indian breakfast items such as idli, vada and dosa, select rice dishes, tea and coffee.

The official said the food trucks would also operate in high-footfall areas in Bengaluru and Mysuru, including Lalbagh, Cubbon Park, Palace Grounds, the Kadalekai Parishes venue and Mysuru Palace. The menu can be modified depending on the tourist destination and the number of visitors it attracts. The food trucks will serve only vegetarian food. Providing employment opportunities to local people and giving priority to regional cuisine are among the key objectives of the initiative.

The official said this would be the first such project in the country where a government organisation operates food trucks at tourist destinations where setting up permanent restaurants is not possible.

The operating hours of the food trucks will also vary depending on the location. For instance, at Nandi Hills, where tourists arrive early in the morning and queue up at the foothills, some food trucks will begin operations as early as 3 am to provide hot food to visitors.

Tourism Secretary Dr Ram Prasath Manohar said food was an important part of the overall tourism experience. Through 'Mayura Ruchi on Wheels', KSTDC's hospitality services would be brought closer to tourists, he said.

WINDOWS

Hospital launches Envision by inMode

BENGALURU : Nethradhama Super Speciality Eye Hospital has become Karnataka's first hospital to introduce Envision by inMode, offering non-surgical treatment targeting dry eye causes, including meibomian gland dysfunction and eyelid inflammation. The 10-12-minute procedure uses Forma-I and Lumeca-I technologies, providing comfortable treatment without downtime for patients in Bengaluru.

Sonu Sood being care giver

BENGALURU : Actor and philanthropist Sonu Sood reflected on his own care-giving experience after watching 'Mr Med's on short film 'Kuch Hoga Toh Batana'. The film highlights caregivers' sacrifices while supporting loved ones through prolonged treatment and recovery.

K'taka ranks next to TN in south for groundwater-recharge water bodies

HANS NEWS SERVICE
BENGALURU

NEARLY 30 per cent of Karnataka's water bodies currently in use primarily serve the purpose of groundwater recharge, highlighting the role of lakes, tanks and other traditional water structures in strengthening the state's water security, Minor Irrigation and Science and Technology Minister Dr Ajay Dharma Singh said.

According to the Second Census of Water Bodies conducted by the Union Ministry of Jal Shakti, Karnataka has 28,075 water bodies in use. Of these, 8,353, or 29.8 per cent, are primarily used for groundwater recharge.

Karnataka's share is higher than that of Telangana, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala, while Tamil Nadu has a higher proportion at 34.3 per cent. The corresponding

figures are 27.5 per cent for Telangana, 19.2 per cent for Andhra Pradesh and 15.3 per cent for Kerala.

Dr. Ajay Dharma Singh said the figures should be viewed in the context of Karnataka's recurring rainfall variability and drought conditions, which make groundwater recharge an important component of long-term water management.

"Lakes, tanks and other water bodies are not just storage structures; they are systems that help secure our groundwater for the future," he said. Around 96 per cent of Karnataka's water bodies are located in rural areas. Their conservation and recharge potential therefore have a direct bearing on agriculture, drinking water availability, livestock and rural livelihoods, the minister said.

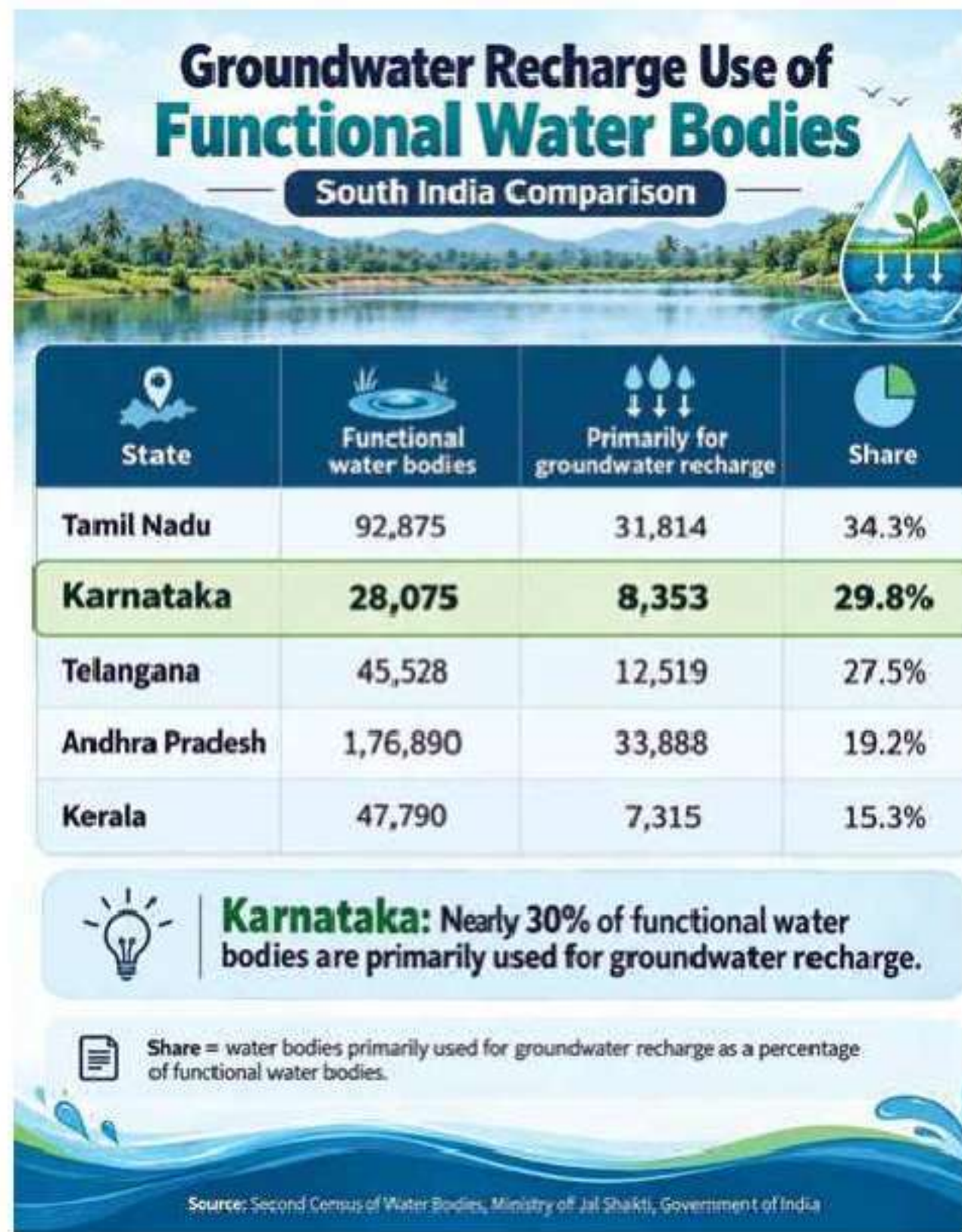
Of the 8,353 water bodies primarily serving groundwa-

ter recharge, 5,302 are classified as water bodies, while 1,548 are lakes and 1,267 are ponds. The figures underline the continuing role of traditional water systems in maintaining groundwater levels.

The minister said the focus should now be on protecting catchment areas and improving the recharge capacity of existing water bodies.

"The next step must be to integrate watershed protection, desilting, restoration of lakes and rainwater harvesting with groundwater management. Strengthening the recharge capacity of rural water bodies will be a key priority," he said.

The government intends to use the data from the water bodies census to strengthen conservation and recharge measures, particularly in rural areas where the majority of the state's water resources are located.



SLBC tunnel project: Uttam announces breakthrough

EXCAVATION WORK CROSSES MAJOR GEOLOGICAL SHEAR ZONE

- 700 m excavation completed over five to six months
- This includes 450 m from the outlet and 250 m from the inlet
- The 43.968-km main tunnel is approximately 79% complete



HANS NEWS SERVICE
HYDERABAD

EXCAVATION work on the Srisailem Left Bank Canal tunnel has crossed a major geological hurdle, paving the way for faster construction and deployment of additional equipment, Irrigation and Civil Supplies Minister N Uttam Kumar Reddy said on Sunday. Reviewing irrigation projects in erstwhile Nalgonda district alongside

elected representatives and senior officials, Uttam focused on the SLBC tunnel, which is expected to deliver over 30 TMC of water to upland areas.

Officials reported that around 700 m of excavation were completed over five to six months, comprising 450 m from the outlet and 250 m from the inlet while negotiating an unstable shear zone. The 43.968-km main tunnel is approximately 79

per cent complete, leaving 9.1 km remaining. Uttam directed officials to maintain momentum while prioritizing worker safety over 20 km inside the tunnel.

Indian Army tunnel expert Col Parikshit Mehra explained that inlet excavation was initially slowed by weak rock, rock bursts, and safety concerns. The team installed 140-mm seamless pipes to create an umbrella canopy alongside reinforced

ribs, staged excavation, and probe drilling. The combined excavation rate currently averages seven to eight metres daily. A three-arm drilling boomer operates at the outlet, while another reaches the inlet in October alongside electric loaders and excavators. A German locomotive arriving by October end will improve muck removal over 21 km distances.

The construction cycle has

dropped from 48 hours to 20–24 hours, with officials expecting a reduction to 10 hours from late October or early November.

Uttam stated Tunnel 1 could achieve breakthrough by May–June 2028, directing timely completion of Tunnel 2, balancing reservoirs, and associated infrastructure. Tunnel 2, measuring 7.1 km, has resumed lining work after a prolonged interruption.

Achieving BC rights is the goal: Veerlapalli

SHIVA KUMAR
SHADNAGAR

LOCAL MLA Veerlapalli Shankar stated that the goal is to move forward with the mission of achieving the rights of the Backward Classes (BCs). He emphasized that they will continue to build on the Central government until the OBC caste census is conducted.

Congress leaders, activists, and supporters from Shadnagar traveled in large numbers to the OBC public meeting at Gollapalli in Shamshabad. Under the leadership of OBC Chairman and MLA Veerlapalli, the convoy of over a thousand vehicles first visited the Anjaneya Swamy temple at Choudammagutta.

Later, upon reaching the town's main junction, activists welcomed them with slogans. MLA Shankar paid floral tributes at the statue of Dr BR Ambedkar. Leaders and activists honored him with garlands, while fireworks and slogans created a festive atmosphere

Thousands travel to the OBC Sabha



at the junction. The convoy then proceeded to the OBC Sabha.

Shankar said that caste census is crucial for the social and political upliftment of BCs. He stressed the need to move forward unitedly to achieve rights. He expressed gratitude to the OBCs, leaders, and activists who came together to attend the Sabha.

The event was attended by former MPP Shivasankar

Goud, Market Committee Vice Chairman Mohamad Ali Khan Babar, Raghunayak, Balaraju Goud, Municipal Chairman Agganur Basaveshwar, Vice Chairman Ande Mohan, KK Krishna, Challa Srikanth Reddy, Chendi Tirupathi Reddy, Krishna Reddy, Jangari Ravi, Jamrud Khan, Ibrahim, Gutta Raju, Neerati Vasu, Manish, Sridhar Varma, and many others.

Congress govt committed to RTC workers' welfare: MLA Nagaraju

MLA urges employees to back TWU-SWF-INTUC alliance for rights, job security and better working conditions

HANS NEWS SERVICE
HANUMAKONDA

VARDHANNAPET MLA and retired IPS officer KR Nagaraju said the Congress government is committed to the welfare of RTC workers and strengthening the organisation. He urged employees to remain united to protect their rights, job security and working conditions.

Nagaraju was speaking at an election campaign organised at the Hanumakonda local depot on Sunday in support of candidates of the TWU-SWF-INTUC united alliance. He appealed to RTC workers to extend their



full support to the alliance candidates in the elections.

The MLA said the Congress government had been giving priority to the welfare of employees and workers and taking steps to address their concerns. He assured the workers that he would

take up their issues with the government and make efforts to resolve them.

Warangal DCC president Mohammed Ayub, Congress leaders, RTC trade union representatives, activists and workers participated in the campaign.

PONGULETI DISTRIBUTES CHEQUES TO BENEFICIARIES

HANS NEWS SERVICE
KHAMMAM

REVENUE Minister Ponguleti Srinivas Reddy on Sunday said the state government was committed to the welfare of poor and needy people. The Minister distributed Kalyana Lakshmi, Shaadi Mubarak and Chief Minister's Relief Fund (CMRF) cheques to beneficiaries from Edulapuram Municipality and Khammam Rural Mandal at his camp office in Khammam. As many as 51 beneficiaries from Khammam Rural Mandal received Kalyana Lakshmi cheques worth Rs 50.05 lakh. Under the CMRF, 70 beneficiaries from Edulapuram Municipality received Rs



23.66 lakh, while 95 beneficiaries from Khammam Rural Mandal received Rs 28.79 lakh.

In all, 216 beneficiaries received financial assistance totalling Rs 1.02 crore. Of these, 165 beneficiaries received CMRF assistance amounting to

Rs 52.45 lakh. Speaking on the occasion, Ponguleti said the CMRF scheme was providing crucial financial support to poor and middle-class families who had undergone emergency medical treatment at corporate and private hospitals.

He said the government was committed to being a people-oriented government and was implementing welfare schemes on a larger scale to extend greater benefits to the public compared with previous administrations.

The beneficiaries expressed their gratitude to the Minister for the financial assistance.

Camp office in-charge Thumburu Dayakar Reddy, Congress Khammam Rural Mandal president Thota Veerabhadram, Edulapuram Municipality Congress president Banoth Kishore Naik, along with public representatives, Congress leaders and activists, attended the programme.

Referral nexus raises healthcare concerns in Nizamabad

RMPs accused of pushing patients to private hospitals for commissions, lavish incentives and unnecessary treatments

HANS NEWS SERVICE
NIZAMABAD

CONCERNS over an alleged referral nexus involving rural medical practitioners (RMPs), private hospitals and diagnostic centres are growing in Nizamabad district, with allegations that patients are being referred based on commissions rather than medical necessity.

The issue came to light after a youth from Armoor, who developed sudden fluctuations in blood pressure, was allegedly declared critical by a local RMP and shifted to a private hospital in Nizamabad. He was admitted to the ICU for nearly a week and the family was reportedly billed around Rs 2 lakh. A qualified doctor in the family later questioned the need for prolonged ICU care and extensive tests, following which the matter was reportedly settled.

Sources also alleged that some hospitals offer incentives, including foreign trips and weekend parties, to high-referring practitioners.

Activists have demanded an audit of ICU admissions, billing records and referral practices, besides strict action against violations.

Mahabubabad woman dies in road accident in US

HYDERABAD: A 31-year-old woman from Mahabubabad district died in a road accident in Missouri, USA, on Sunday. The deceased, Daram Supriya, a married woman from Maripeda Mandal headquarters, had been residing in Missouri in connection with her employment. According to information available, the car in which Supriya

was travelling was hit from behind by a truck at around 2 am (IST). She died on the spot, while another Indian woman travelling in the car reportedly sustained serious injuries. Supriya's husband, Kodumuri Ranjith, and her in-laws, Kodumuri Venkateswarlu and Radhika, reside at Veerabhadra Apartments in Mahabubabad town.



Daram Supriya

Cong unable to accept Modi's third-term mandate: NRR

HANS NEWS SERVICE
HYDERABAD

BJP Telangana State president N Ramchander Rao (NRR) launched a sharp attack on the Congress on Sunday, alleging that the party was unable to accept the people's mandate in favour of Narendra Modi, who became Prime Minister for a third consecutive term.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP's state headquarters, Rao said the Congress had suffered defeats in several States and in three consecutive Lok Sabha elections, yet its leadership was unable to come to terms with the fact that voters had rejected the party and backed Modi for a third term as Prime Minister.

He alleged that Congress leaders were operating with a "monarchical" mindset, believing that the Prime Minister's post belonged exclusively to the Nehru-Gandhi family, and were misleading the people with such an approach.

Rao also criticised the Congress leadership for failing to accept the changing political preferences of the electorate and the repeated electoral mandate in favour of Modi.

He expressed outrage over Congress National President Mallikarjun Kharge's statements calling all elections held in the country a farce and demanding their cancellation. Condemning such comments, Rao asserted that questioning the people's mandate is an insult not only to voters of this country, but to Indian democracy itself.

BJP state chief accused Rahul Gandhi and forces like Prakash Raj for joining hands in a conspiracy to erode public trust in



independent constitutional bodies such as the Supreme Court of India, the President's Office, and the Election Commission of India (ECI). He criticized Congress for attempting to weaken these systems and jeopardize the country's integrity.

Clarifying allegations made by the Congress regarding the ongoing SIR process in Hyderabad city, Rao asserted that there is no truth to their claims. He made it clear that this process is being conducted entirely by the state government machinery, and decisions on deleting votes are taken only after the Election Commission conducts field-level inquiries into any objections. He reminded that simply submitting Form-7 does not automatically lead to voter deletion and the Form-7 mechanism exists per rules specifically to weed out fake and duplicate votes. He further clarified that no Booth Level Agents (BLA-1, BLA-2) belonging to the BJP have submitted any such applications. He mocked the Congress party saying it has become a habit for them to praise systems as functioning properly whenever they win an election, but blame EVMs and the SIR process whenever they lose.

Ponnam calls for nationwide caste census

HANS NEWS SERVICE
HYDERABAD

BACKWARD Classes Welfare and Transport Minister Ponnam Prabhakar on Sunday called for a nationwide caste census, describing it as essential for social justice, equal opportunities, and political representation. Speaking at a TPCC OBC public meeting in Shamshabad, Prabhakar highlighted that Telangana, under Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy, set a national example alongside Bihar by conducting a comprehensive caste census using lakhs of government employees.

Emphasizing that the census concerns national rights for backward sections, Prabhakar called for a grassroots movement using rallies, round-table discussions, and public meetings.



He recalled historical unity during the Telangana movement and freedom struggle, urging similar solidarity to secure political representation from Gram Panchayats to Parliament. Noting that the Telangana Assembly passed a resolution seeking 42 per cent reservation for BCs based on survey data, he called for a nationwide debate on the 50 per cent reservation ceiling. Prabhakar urged the Union government to exercise its constitutional powers to

conduct a national census, suggesting Gram Sabhas pass supporting resolutions while reaffirming Telangana backing for the movement led by Rahul Gandhi.

TPCC President and MLC Mahesh Kumar Goud stated that Rahul Gandhi gave BC communities confidence to demand rights, expressing certainty that a BC leader would eventually become Telangana Chief Minister. Asserting that Congress would fight for BC rights, Goud

urged the community to set aside internal caste differences. He criticized the BJP-led Union government for excluding the OBC column from its census while retaining SC and ST categories.

Goud praised Chief Minister Revanth Reddy, Deputy Chief Minister Bhatti Vikramarka, and the Cabinet for completing the state survey. He noted that over 55 per cent of sarpanches elected in local body polls belonged to BC communities and that Congress allocated 58 per cent of municipal seats to BC candidates. Reaffirming commitments to increase BC representation in the Cabinet, Legislative Council, and state corporations, Goud promised that Congress would conduct a nationwide caste survey upon assuming power at the Centre.

Restaurants and bars shut from today

TELANGANA BAR AND RESTAURANT OWNERS CALL FOR SHUTDOWN PROTEST FROM TODAY

Following the call for a shutdown, over 1,200 bars and restaurants across the State are set to close. The Association representatives stated that the strike would continue until the government responds

HANS NEWS SERVICE
HYDERABAD

MEMBERS of the Bar and Restaurant Owners' Association in Telangana announced that establishments across the state would remain closed starting on Monday. They alleged that they were suffering severe financial losses due to the new 'privilege fee' (cess) being



introduced by the state government and were demanding its immediate withdrawal.

Protesting the government's decision, they have called for a state-wide shutdown from Monday. Additionally, the members of the Telangana State Bar and Restaurant Owners' Association stated that

they plan to lay siege to the Excise Department office on the 5th of the month.

"The state government has decided to collect an annual 'privilege cess' ranging from 8% to 20% from each bar. The Association members state that this move would impose an additional financial burden of approximately Rs 30 lakh per year on each bar," said a statement from the members.

They also expressed distress over existing challenges such as the authorization of 'permanent rooms' at wine shops and the proliferation of unauthorized 'belt shops,' which are already causing them significant financial loss.

State President of the Bar and Restaurant Owners Association Damodar Goud stated that despite

facing numerous hardships, they already pay the government between Rs 33 lakh and Rs 56 lakh annually in license fees and added that an additional burden of up to Rs 30 lakh was being imposed under the guise of a "privilege cess." He demanded the immediate withdrawal of this proposed cess while warning that they would stage a protest at the Excise Commissioner's office.

Meanwhile, following the call for a shutdown, over 1,200 bars and restaurants across Telangana are set to close.

The Association representatives have stated that the strike would continue until the government respond and added that if their demands are not met, they would resort to hunger strikes and escalate their agitation in the future.

Decriminalising GST regime augurs well

The goods and services tax (GST) regime, which began in July 2017, is likely to undergo a major change: decriminalising offences under the indirect tax regime. The GST Council, the final decision-making body that comprises representatives from the Central and state governments, is expected to deliberate over the matter. If the revamp is accepted, it will be a boost for the business and trading communities. The objective behind the proposal is to boost investor sentiment and allay concerns about overreach by tax authorities. The federal body has reportedly held several meetings over the last eight to nine months. The extant criminalisation provisions are detested in trading and industrial

circles. Arrests of a few high-profile persons in the recent past have been widely criticised. The government wants GST frauds to be penalised under the criminal code, the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. It is not that there are no legal safeguards against the abuse of powers by GST authorities. Sub-section (1) of Section 69 of the CGST Act merely requires “reasons to believe” a person’s culpability are not enough; there must be credible material and evidence to back that belief; mere suspicion is not sufficient. The industry’s experience, however, is different; business representatives have highlighted instances of harassment, especially in the services sector. It must be noted that arrest powers under

GST laws were flagged by several states earlier, too; in fact, even before the indirect tax regime came into force. In December 2016, the Maharashtra Additional Chief Secretary had pointed out in the fifth GST Council that the power of arrest and confiscation was at variance with the concept of ease of doing business. Just before the GST rollout, the then Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee had opposed the arrest clause. “I am shocked to find that the GST rules contain a rather draconian arrest clause, which can lead to major harassment of businesses, particularly small and medium traders. Some sections are even non-bailable,” she said, as traders across Bengal went on a strike against the implementation of GST

and vented their ire at this specific clause. It was just a politician trying to score a point; small and medium traders, who have been among the Bharatiya Janata Party’s core constituencies, were also shocked by the criminalisation provisions. It is a sad commentary on the Narendra Modi government’s responsiveness to the concerns of a large section of its main supporters; it took the policy and decision makers nine years to realise that wealth creators have suffered because of an anti-business provision in a major reform that it has been peddling as a big success ever since the GST rollout. The irony is obvious: a government that has repeatedly emphasised the importance of ease of doing business has allowed

a regime to persist in which businessmen and entrepreneurs have had to contend with the threat of arrest, prosecution, and prolonged legal battles over tax-related disputes. Such provisions not only undermine confidence among existing businesses but also discourage prospective investors, particularly smaller enterprises that lack the financial resources and legal expertise to defend themselves against the state’s might. Criminalisation provisions create an atmosphere of fear and distrust between tax authorities and the business community; they empower crooked officials to weaponise these provisions. The government’s belated willingness to reconsider these provisions is, therefore, welcome.



LETTERS

Singeetham remained an unsung hero

It is indeed sad that legendary filmmaker Singeetham Srinivasa Rao is no more. One of Indian cinema’s most inventive filmmakers, he remained remarkably unsung at the national level and was never considered for the Dadasaheb Phalke award during his lifetime. His Pushpaka Vimanam, made without conventional dialogue, remains a landmark in visual storytelling. Even more remarkable was his final film, Sing Geetham, made at the age of 94—a unique experiment in which the characters sing their lines. Rao did not need an award to establish his place in cinema. His contributions deserved recognition in his lifetime and not any posthumous gesture. Regional film makers must institute a “Singeetham Srinivas Rao” award in line with Dadasaheb.

N Nagarajan, Hyderabad-103

A doyen of Tollywood industry

The passing of veteran filmmaker Singeetham Srinivasa Rao at the age of 96 marks the end of an illustrious chapter in Telugu cinema. His association with films began nearly seven decades ago as an assistant director in the iconic Mayabazar. He went on to direct nearly 60 films and earned a special place in the annals of Indian cinema. His memorable works include Pushpaka Vimanam, Mayuri, Aditya 369 and Bhairava Dweepam. With his wife having predeceased him, Singeetham leaves behind generations of admirers, disciples and followers. His distinctive contribution to cinema will continue to be remembered with affection and respect.

N Ramalakshmi, Secunderabad-10

“Versatile artiste”

He etched his name permanently in the hearts of people as “Versatile Sangeetham - Singeetham Srinivasa Rao” ... an innovative - experimental - versatile director who made movies of all genres, with melodious music and songs, apart from novel themes, story line and treatment. Thus, they enthralled the public and thus he became the darling - director or people’s - director. He directed around 60 movies across multiple genres and languages, including telugu, kannada, tamil, hindi, and English. Versatility was his forte. He won many awards - rewards at national and state level, filmfare awards too. A few movies at a glance:- social problem (Tharam marindi), telugu - Indian culture (America Ammal), folklore (Bhairava Dweepam), science fiction (Adithya 369), silent movie (Pushpaka Vimanam), dance movie (Mayuri), mythology (Sri krishnarjuna Vijayam), hero in quadruplet role (Michael Madana Kama Raju), humour (Gammathu Goodacharulu, Sommokadidi Sokokadidi), female oriented - serious (Zamintharu gari ammayi), hero in a woman’s get up (Madam), hero as a dwarf (Apoorva Sahodarulu), animation movie (son of Aladdin), “only songs” movie (Sing - Geetham: his last movie in 2026, he at 95 years age).

PVP Madhu Nirvriti, Secunderabad-61

A Tollywood legend like no other

Singeetam Srinivasa Rao, cinema’s eternal maverick, leaves behind a remarkable legacy of imagination, innovation and versatility. From Tamil classics like Dikkatra Parvathi, Raja Paarvai, Apoorva Sagodharargal and Michael Madana Kama Rajan to Telugu landmarks such as Mayuri, Aditya 369 and Bhairava Dweepam, he constantly pushed the boundaries of storytelling. His dialogue-free Pesum Padam remains a bold experiment that transcended language. A director, writer, producer and actor, Singeetam embraced every facet of filmmaking with curiosity and courage. His enduring collaborations with Kamal Haasan produced some of Indian cinema’s most inventive works. Even in his nineties, he remained active, proving that cinema was inseparable from his life.

A P Thiruvadi, Chennai

Nari shakti dazzles on golden day for India

Kudos to Team India for a golden haul on Saturday - Gold in hockey, cricket, wrestling, golf and archery, taking its overall medal tally to 21 gold, 27 silver and 37 bronze medals. Meanwhile, a special salute to the men’s hockey team for beating Malaysia 5-1 to retain the Asia title and qualify for the 2028 Olympics, and to Nari Shakti for bringing home gold in cricket, archery and golf, among other disciplines. A golden day indeed.

Ganti Venkata Sudhir, Secunderabad

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BENGALURU ONLINE

Congress names 25 MLAs for corporation, board posts

BENGALURU: The Congress has finalised the names of 25 MLAs for appointment as chairpersons of major corporations and boards in Karnataka and is awaiting the Election Commission’s approval in view of the model code of conduct for the Legislative Council elections.

Official orders are expected to be issued once the Election Commission gives its consent. After the appointment orders for the MLAs are issued, the party is likely to nominate senior leaders to other corporation and board positions. The appointments are expected to be taken up largely after the restructuring of the Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC).

With a series of elections, including Zilla Panchayat and Taluk Panchayat polls, expected ahead, the Congress is also undertaking an organisational revamp. Along with changes in office-bearers and the formation of a new executive committee, the process of setting up a Political Affairs Committee to improve coordination between the party and the government has also begun.

There is growing pressure within the ruling party for the Political Affairs Committee to be formed so that major policy decisions can be discussed on the party platform in advance.

Read more at <https://epaper.thehansindia.com>

Justice must not only be done but also remain beyond doubt

CHOLLETI

When a retired Supreme Court judge joins the governing body of a Reliance-backed wildlife initiative, a legitimate question arises. It is not whether he did anything wrong. It is whether the institution he served can still persuade citizens that nothing was wrong.

Former Supreme Court judge Justice Krishna Murari, who served on the apex court from 2019 until his retirement in 2023, joined in September 2026 the five-member Governing Council of Vantara, the animal welfare initiative of Reliance Industries and Reliance Foundation.

An investigation by Article 14 reports that he was involved in proceedings that enabled Vantara’s acquisition of elephants, its operation as a private zoo, and the nationwide expansion of a committee that oversaw elephant transfers to the facility, and that he joined its top governing body three years after retiring.

It is worth being precise about what is and is not alleged. In August 2022, Justice Murari sat on a bench that declined to interfere with a High Court order permitting elephant transfers to a temple trust later linked to Vantara. There is no general cooling-off rule preventing a retired Supreme Court judge from accepting such a private-sector or non-profit governance role. Nobody has produced evidence of a quid pro quo. The gap of three years is

long by the standards of such appointments. Neither Vantara nor Justice Murari’s office responded to probing media queries. The judge may well have a complete answer, and he deserves the chance to give it.

But the matter does not end with an absence of proof. Public confidence rests on appearances, and the appearances here are uncomfortable.

A pattern, not an aberration:

Vantara is not the first such episode. It is the latest in a long line, mostly in public office rather than private enterprise.

No court has ever held, and this piece does not allege, that any specific judgment was influenced by the promise of a future post. But the recurrence of the pattern, its timing, and the judiciary’s own reluctance to self-regulate have made “post-retirement sinecures” one of the most serious credibility challenges facing India’s higher judiciary today.

Former Chief Justice of India P Sathasivam, who retired in April 2014, was appointed Governor of Kerala that November. Ranjan Gogoi, who demitted office as Chief Justice of India in November 2019, was nominated to the Rajya Sabha within months. The nomination drew sharp criticism. Opposition MPs asked whether it was a quid pro quo and how the public could have faith in judicial independence.

In February 2023, the President appointed Justice



Some judges have set a better example. CJI B R Gavai said before taking office that he would accept no post-retirement assignment. His predecessor, Sanjiv Khanna, also said he would not accept any official role after retiring. Personal resolve of this kind deserves public respect, but it is a voluntary pledge, not a rule

S Abdul Nazeer as Governor of Andhra Pradesh just 40 days after his retirement. He was part of the Ayodhya bench and had headed the Constitution bench that upheld demonetisation. Of the four retired judges on the Ayodhya bench, three had by then received government posts within months of their respective retirements.

In 2021, Justice Arun Mishra became NHRC chairperson almost nine months after retiring from the Supreme Court and was criticised for his earlier public praise of the Prime Minister at a judicial conference. Rights groups objected, and they said the appointment violated the Paris Principles governing national human rights institutions.

None of these judges has been shown to have decided any case with an eye on a

future job. Each of them would reject the suggestion, and the law does not allow us to assume otherwise. Yet the sequence, a major judgment followed by a prized appointment, invites the very inference that a judiciary must work hardest to forestall.

The warnings were ignored:

This concern is not new. The Law Commission, in its 232nd report in 2009, observed that sitting judges seek such appointments either on the eve of their retirement or after it. In 2013, a senior parliamentarian told the Rajya Sabha that the country was going too far in creating post-retirement avenues for judges in every new legislation. Yet in 2019 the Government told the Rajya Sabha that it did not intend to make a cooling-off

period mandatory.

Here the responsibility is shared. The executive offers the posts, and it is the largest litigant before the courts. Judges accept them. Private enterprises, which increasingly appear in high-stakes constitutional and regulatory litigation, now join the list of potential patrons.

The honourable exceptions:

A fair account must acknowledge two things. First, some judges have set a better example. CJI B R Gavai said before taking office that he would accept no post-retirement assignment. His predecessor, Sanjiv Khanna, also said he would not accept any official role after retiring. Personal resolve of this kind deserves public respect, but it is a voluntary pledge, not a rule. Second, retired judges bring real expertise. Tribunals, inquiry commissions and oversight bodies often need exactly that experience. A Special Investigation Team, led by former Supreme Court judge Jasti Chelameswar, was used in the Vantara matter itself. Nobody sensible would bar retired judges from public service altogether. The argument is about timing, transparency and the nature of the post, not about whether a judge may ever work again.

What should be done:

The remedy lies in rules, not in recrimination. Three steps are worth considering.

First, a cooling-off period, perhaps two years, before a retired Supreme Court or

High Court judge accepts any executive appointment, political nomination or board position in an entity that has been a party before him. Legislation or a binding Full Court resolution could provide this.

Second, disclosure norms. Judges might be required to disclose, on appointment and again on retirement, any prospect of post-retirement engagement, and to recuse themselves from matters involving potential future employers.

Third, a clear distinction between quasi-judicial roles that are statutorily meant for judges, such as tribunals, and discretionary patronage posts. The first is a necessary part of the justice system. The second is where suspicion grows.

The stakes:

The judiciary’s only real currency is public trust. The conviction that a judge’s decisions come from the law and not from expectations of reward is not a courtesy to the judge. It is the foundation of the institution.

A judge who rules fairly and later takes a position that looks like a reward has still hurt the court, even when his conscience is clear. Fairness requires that no one gains a plausible reason to doubt the judgment that came before. If the higher judiciary wants to keep its authority, it should not wait for Parliament. It can set the standard itself.

(The writer is with the Cholleti BlackRobe Chambers, Hyderabad, and writes on the economy, politics and law)

A tale of two cities: Unmasking the reality of Hyderabad’s urban boom

NOMULA SRINIVAS RAO

“Cities have the capability of providing something for everybody, only because, and only when, they are created by everybody.”

— Jane Jacobs

Walk through the glass-and-steel corridors of Narsingi or Kokapet at dusk, and you are greeted by an unapologetic spectacle of global ambition. Towering residential skyscrapers slice into the horizon, their reflective facades catching the fading light. High-speed flyovers, sleek metro lines, and multi-lane expressways weave through the western sector like the arteries of a hyper-modern metropolis. This is the headline-grabbing face of Hyderabad’s real estate narrative: a booming IT-driven economy, soaring property valuations, and luxury gated communities that promise an international lifestyle wrapped in urban convenience.

Yet, just a few kilometers away, a parallel reality unfolds—one of narrow

lanes, aging stormwater drains, and sprawling historic neighborhoods straining under the weight of rapid, uneven growth. This stark duality forms the complex ground reality of modern Hyderabad: a city racing toward a futuristic ideal while navigating the frictional drag of infrastructure gaps and socio-spatial division.

The western engine and the capital surge:

Over the past decade, Hyderabad’s growth engine has pulled decisively toward its Western Corridor. Driven by the influx of Global Capability Centres (GCCs), tech giants, and pharmaceutical heavyweights, regions like Gachibowli, the Financial District, and Tellaapur have witnessed unprecedented capital appreciation.

The modern homebuyers in Western Hyderabad are no longer simply buying square footage; they are purchasing an ecosystem. Integrated townships offer private power backups, water filtration, private parks, and walk-to-work proximity. However, this



self-contained model hints at a broader urban phenomenon: the privatization of civic infrastructure.

The infrastructure paradox:

While projects like the Outer Ring Road (ORR) and expanding Metro Rail corridors have revolutionised long-distance transit across the city, local civic infrastructure frequently struggles to keep pace with high-density construction.

When torrential monsoon downpours hit, the contrast becomes starkly visible. Modern glass towers often find themselves encircled by waterlogged roads as natural

catchment zones and historic lake basins (cheruvus) yield to concrete developments. The city’s water supply presents a similar paradox: while smart apartments feature automated tap systems, many outlying clusters remain dependent on private water tankers to meet daily needs.

Furthermore, property prices—averaging around ₹8,200 to ₹8,300 per square foot citywide, with premium pockets reaching far higher—have created a distinct affordability gap.

Middle-class buyers and long-time residents are increasingly pushed toward distant peripheral zones like

Bachupally or Kollur, trading reasonable commute times for affordable square footage.

Toward a polycentric tomorrow:

To view Hyderabad strictly through the lens of its challenges, however, is to miss its extraordinary resilience and potential. Unlike cities constrained by geography, Hyderabad possesses a natural advantage: radial room to expand.

The ongoing push toward a polycentric urban model aims to decentralize growth away from a single western cluster. Key initiatives are reshaping the landscape:

Regional Ring Road (RRR): A planned 340-km mega-loop designed to connect satellite towns directly, reducing core city congestion.

Transit-Oriented Development (TOD): Densifying commercial and residential spaces directly along Metro Phase 2 corridors to decrease reliance on private vehicles.

Industrial and health clusters: Strategic investments in southern and eastern

corridors—such as life sciences nodes and AI hubs—to distribute employment opportunities evenly across the metropolitan region.

If these macro-planning efforts successfully integrate basic municipal services—drainage, public green spaces, and reliable water networks—with private development, Hyderabad can bridge the divide between its glitzy present and an inclusive future. The urban reality of Hyderabad is neither a pure real estate paradise nor a cautionary tale of unplanned expansion. It is a dynamic, evolving metropolis in the middle of a massive structural transition. As high-rises continue to alter the skyline, the city’s true measure of success will not lie merely in the height of its towers or the speed of its stock market returns, but in how seamlessly it blends its historic soul with its high-tech future.

We shape our buildings; thereafter, our buildings shape us - Winston Churchill

(The writer is a former OSD to Union Civil Aviation Minister)

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AITUC calls for united struggle against anti-worker policies

HANS NEWS SERVICE
KURNOOL

THE government should constitute a welfare board for auto workers and extend financial assistance to those depending on auto-rickshaw driving for their livelihood, AP Auto Motor Transport Workers Union State General Secretary A Eswar and AITUC district general secretary Nakkli Lenin Babu demanded.

They were speaking at the district council meeting of the AP Auto Workers Union held at Indrajit Gupta Bhavan here on Sunday, with district president M Madhu presiding.

Eswar and Lenin Babu said many educated youth were driving auto-rickshaws to support their families without depending on the government. They alleged that the



AITUC leader addressing a meeting in Kurnool on Sunday

government had promised a welfare board before the elections but failed to implement it, demanding adequate fund allocation to extend welfare schemes through a single mechanism.

Highlighting that there are around 11.70 lakh auto workers in the State representing nearly 33 lakh votes, they urged authorities not to ignore their concerns. They also demanded an end to

police harassment and heavy penalties for overloading and pollution certificate issues, while seeking interest-free bank loans for purchasing auto-rickshaws.

AITUC senior leader N Manohar Manikyam stated that workers could secure solutions only through sustained struggles, calling upon them to prepare for agitations against the coalition government's anti-worker policies.

Govt committed to welfare of BCs: MLA

- States that the coalition government is fully committed to improving the socio-economic conditions of BCs through targeted welfare and development measures
- Efforts are underway to boost educational opportunities, youth employment avenues, self-employment financial assistance, and ensure welfare schemes reach every eligible family

HANS NEWS SERVICE
DHONE

DHONE MLA Kotla Jaya Surya Prakash Reddy stated that the coalition government is firmly committed to the welfare and all-round development of Backward Classes (BCs), implementing several measures to uplift their socio-economic conditions.

He was speaking as the chief guest at the state-level meeting of the National BC Welfare Association held at the New Madhu Function Hall on Sunday, where association leaders accorded him a warm welcome.

The MLA emphasized that BCs play a significant role in societal development and stressed the need to prioritize progress in education,



Dhone MLA Kotla Jaya Surya Prakash Reddy addressing a meeting on Sunday

employment, and economic sectors.

He noted that the government is actively taking steps to provide better educational opportunities for students, employment av-

enues for youth, and financial assistance for self-employment, ensuring welfare schemes reach every eligible BC family.

Assuring association leaders that he will take necessary

steps to resolve local issues brought to his notice, MLA Kotla reaffirmed the government's sincere commitment to addressing challenges faced by backward communities.

He called upon BC organisations to remain united in safeguarding community rights. Furthermore, he noted that greater progress can be achieved through active coordination between the government, public representatives, and BC groups.

State and district leaders of the National BC Welfare Association, coalition leaders, and members of various BC communities attended the meeting.

Free eye care coupons distributed to working journalists at Press Club



HANS NEWS SERVICE
ANANTAPUR

COUPONS enabling working journalists from print and electronic media to receive free eye care services were distributed at the local Press Club on Sunday.

Organized by the Anantapur Press Club Ad-hoc Committee in collaboration with Dr. Agarwal's Eye Hos-

pital, the facility is available from October 5th to October 10th. Journalists can visit the hospital above the 'Zudio' store on Kalyandurg Road between 10:00 AM and 6:00 PM.

Coupons are allocated as one per family of four, alongside individual passes. Local media leaders and senior journalists participated in the distribution event.

Grand heritage walk organised



HANS NEWS SERVICE
ANANTAPUR

DISTRICT Collector O Anand led a grand heritage walk in Anantapur on Sunday to promote the preservation of historical monuments.

Accompanied by Joint Col-

lector C Vishnu Charan and Assistant Collector Suyash Kumar, the walk commenced at Victoria Memorial Hospital and passed key landmarks including ancient temples, Jamia Masjid, and the Iron Bridge.

Highlighting structures

dating from the 15th century, the administration introduced the state's first 'Blue Plaque' concept.

College students served as guides, while officials and citizens pledged their commitment to safeguarding the city's cultural heritage.

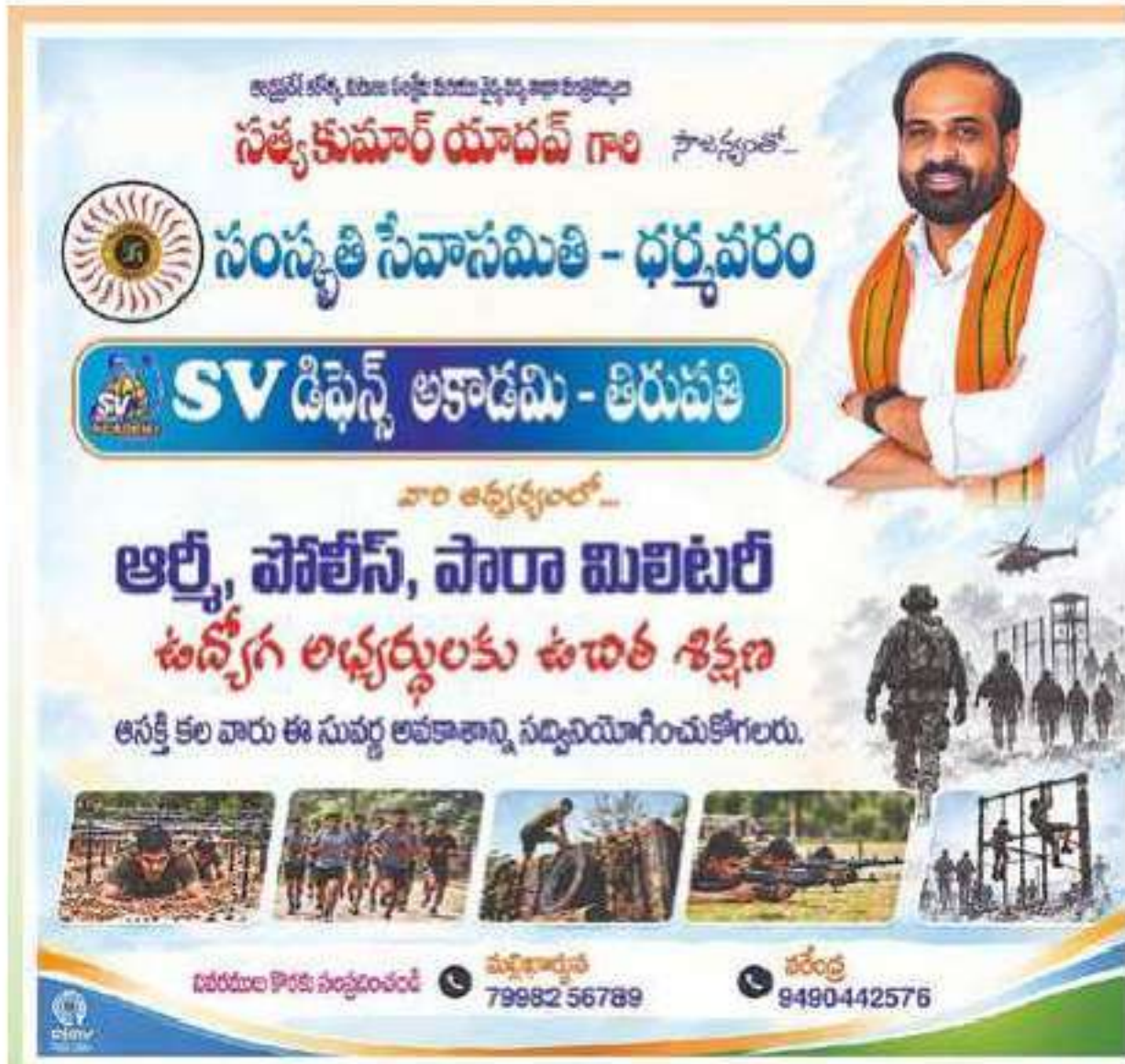
Minister Satya initiates free defence training for youth

HANS NEWS SERVICE
DHARMAVARAM

HEALTH Minister and Dharmavaram MLA Satyakumar Yadav has initiated free defence training for 100 local youths annually to help them secure jobs in the Army, Police, and Paramilitary forces.

Implemented with Samskruti Seva Samiti and SV Defence Academy, the program removes financial barriers for aspiring candidates.

Following the success of 220 candidates in the recent Agniveer drive, this initiative provides specialized coaching in physical fitness and written tests. Interested youth can contact



coordinators Mallikarjuna (9490442576) to access this golden career opportunity.

COURTESY MEETING



Rayadurg MLA and Government Whip Kalava Srinivasulu pays a courtesy visit to Kalyandurg MLA Amilineni Surendra Babu at his residence in Kalyandurg on Sunday

Inter-state thief arrested for snatching gold chains

HANS NEWS SERVICE
KADIRI

KADIRI Town Police arrested inter-state thief B Bhargava, solving 13 theft cases across Sri Sathya Sai, Anantapur, and Annamayya districts, District SP S Satish Kumar announced on Sunday. Operating under a special team led by DSP Siva Narayana Swamy and Inspector B Venkateswarlu, police recovered 140 grams



of gold jewelry worth Rs. 20 lakh and a scooter.

The accused targeted elderly individuals by gaining their trust

and snatched chains in crowded festival areas.

Praising the police team, the SP advised citizens to stay cautious of strangers.

Winners congratulated for demonstrating exceptional skill and competitive spirit

HANS NEWS SERVICE
PUTTAPARTHI

BULLOCK cart races held with great enthusiasm in Pedaballi village drew a large crowd of villagers and young people on Sunday.

Former minister and TDP Puttaparthi constituency in-charge Dr Palle Raghunatha Reddy attended as chief guest, presenting prizes to skilled winners and encouraging organizers.

Highlighting the health benefits of traditional rural competitions, Dr Raghunatha Reddy noted that such events help preserve generations-old



traditions while fostering sportsmanship among the youth. The lively races created a festive atmosphere throughout the village.

Commissioner inspects building works, orders action on violations

HANS NEWS SERVICE
TIRUPATI

MUNICIPAL Corporation Commissioner M Jayakrishna has directed Town Planning officials to take strict action against building constructions being carried out in violation of town planning rules within the Municipal Corporation limits.



Municipal Corporation Commissioner M Jayakrishna inspecting construction works in Tirupati on Sunday

The Commissioner inspected building construction works at several locations in the city along with Town Planning officials on Sunday. He instructed the officials to regularly inspect ongoing construction works across the city along with their staff. The Commissioner directed the officials to check whether the con-

structions have obtained the required permissions from the Town Planning Department and whether the works are being carried out as per the approved plans and regulations.

He ordered immediate strict action against those undertaking construction without permission or violating the prescribed rules.

Balaji hospital successfully saves extremely low birth weight neonate

HANS NEWS SERVICE
KADAPA

A male baby born at 25 weeks weighing just 610 grams successfully recovered after 79 days of intensive care at Balaji Hospital in Kadapa.

Under the expert care of paediatric specialist Dr K Saddam Hussain, the infant received advanced HFOV ventilation, conventional ven-



tilation, and CPAP support. Demonstrating remarkable resilience, the baby was discharged weighing 1.57 kg.

Grateful parents Gangulaiah and Vijaya thanked the doctor and medical team for their dedicated life-saving care.

Peacocks' monsoon dance captivates visitors and nature lovers at Erramala Hills

- Peacocks displaying their colourful plumage and graceful dance have become a major draw for tourists and nature lovers near the Owk Reservoir

- The national bird holds a revered place in Indian culture and Hindu tradition, admired globally for its striking beauty and vibrant feathers

During the monsoon season, the sight of peacocks moving freely against the backdrop of the Erramala hills presents a fascinating visual treat

NARENDRA KUMAR
VARIKUNTALA
NANDYAL

PEACOCKS spreading their colourful plumage and performing their graceful dance have be-

come a major attraction for tourists and nature lovers near the Owk Reservoir in the Erramala hills of Nandyal district.

The sight of the national bird dancing amid scenic hills and natural surround-



A eacock dancing at the Erramala hills on Sunday

ings is drawing visitors keen to capture spectacular moments on their cameras.

Holding a special place in Indian culture and Hindu tradition, the peacock

is admired worldwide for its striking beauty, vibrant feathers, and graceful movements.

Its presence has added further charm to the picturesque surroundings of the Avuku Reservoir. During the monsoon, these birds are frequently seen displaying their magnificent feathers, presenting a fascinating spectacle against the backdrop of the Erramala hills.

Nature enthusiasts are particularly captivated by the birds moving freely in their natural habitat.

The peacock dance has

thus emerged as a premier seasonal attraction of the region. Local nature lovers note that this sight provides a visual treat while highlighting the rich biodiversity of the area.

Furthermore, they expressed hope that the natural habitat of the peacocks would be protected and the area developed responsibly without disturbing the wildlife.

The report underscores the growing popularity of the scenic location among wildlife admirers visiting the district during the seasonal rains.

Police recover 24 stolen bikes, three held

HANS NEWS SERVICE
TIRUPATI

A probe into a string of motorcycle thefts in Tirupati has led police to an interstate vehicle-lifting network, with three habitual offenders arrested and 24 stolen two-wheelers recovered. The vehicles, estimated to be worth about Rs 25 lakh, were reportedly stolen from different parts of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu.

The arrested suspects were identified as Areddula Vinod Kumar (32), Cherlopalli Govindarajulu (34) and Govindaswamy Murali (30). Police said the trio had a history of involvement in vehicle theft

and other offences. Tirupati West police began working on the cases after several motorcycle theft complaints were reported in the city. Special teams examined technical inputs and collected information through local sources, which helped them identify and track the suspects. Of the 24 motorcycles recovered during the operation, nine have already been connected to specific cases registered at different police stations. Efforts are now underway to establish the ownership and case details of the remaining 15 vehicles. According to Tirupati SP L Subba Rayudu, the suspects have several previous cases against their names.



Yami Gautam urges media not to use AI photos without her consent

National award-winning actress Yami Gautam has urged media to take responsibility and not manipulate her pictures with the help of artificial intelligence. With AI content and altered photos of the stars flooding the social media, Yami made a similar appeal in recent times. Taking to X, the actress asked the media to use her pictures that were clicked during her public appearances and insisted that they do not alter a person's image without consent.

Yami's appeal comes after the 'Chuttamalle' AI video controversy with Jr NTR and Janhvi Kapoor. The fabricated video using the superstar's image and the popular song from

Devara went viral recently. NTR strongly condemned the video's circulation and threatened legal action against those responsible for the AI content.

Several actors like Vijay Deverakonda and Chiranjeevi have also spoken out against the misuse of AI-generated content and encouraged taking action against such activities.

While the controversy around AI-manipulated videos of celebrities brews, Yami Gautam is busy promoting her upcoming film 'Nayvi Navelli'. The actress is excited to surprise the audience with a different genre as she prepares to launch the film on October 16, coinciding with Dussehra.

Based in Meerut, the film follows the Awasthi

family as they welcome their new daughter-in-law, Mohini (portrayed by Yami). However, as the narrative unfolds, it takes an unexpected turn, revealing Mohini's mysterious nature. Speaking about the character, Yami mentioned that Mohini is not what she seems to be, saying that he was a mix of friendly and mysterious.

Yami described the film as a blend of family drama, comedy, emotions, fantasy, and action. Directed by Balaji, Nayvi Navelli sees Yami Gautam in a special role and is produced by Colour Yellow Productions and Amazon MGM Studios.

The actress is confident the audience will enjoy watching Mohini when the film releases in theatres.

Womenia

EVERYDAY STYLE

Simple fashion tips to elevate your look

Personal style is all about experimenting, knowing what looks good on you and having fun while doing it



Looking stylish every day doesn't mean spending hours in front of the wardrobe and shopping for new clothes, so why not learn to develop a practical approach to everyday style? A few simple fashion tips will help you look put together even if you're not a fan of shopping.

Start with the right fit

When looking for fashion, knowing what shape you are and what will look good on you for your body shape is the key to great fashion. You can be petite, have an hourglass figure or want to draw attention to your pretty shoulders. The right fit will make you look amazing.

While it's always good to follow the latest styles, remember that age shouldn't define who you are as a fashionista. Your personal style should be able to make you feel confident regardless of what age you are. A fabulous accessory or a flirty skirt can look fabulous on anyone regardless of their age, so don't limit yourself! Remember that personal style is all about experimenting.

Build a capsule wardrobe

The capsule wardrobe is the easiest way to be prepared for any outfitting challenge and save time on decision-making in the week. The capsule wardrobe consists of a few staple pieces that can be paired to make hundreds of outfit combinations.

Investing in a few simple yet elegant pieces like jeans, a little black dress, smart trousers, classic jewellery and pretty tops, you're well on your way to creating a capsule wardrobe. Planning outfits for the week ahead makes a great way to make sure you always have something to wear, and it can also save you time in the mornings.

Let accessories do the work

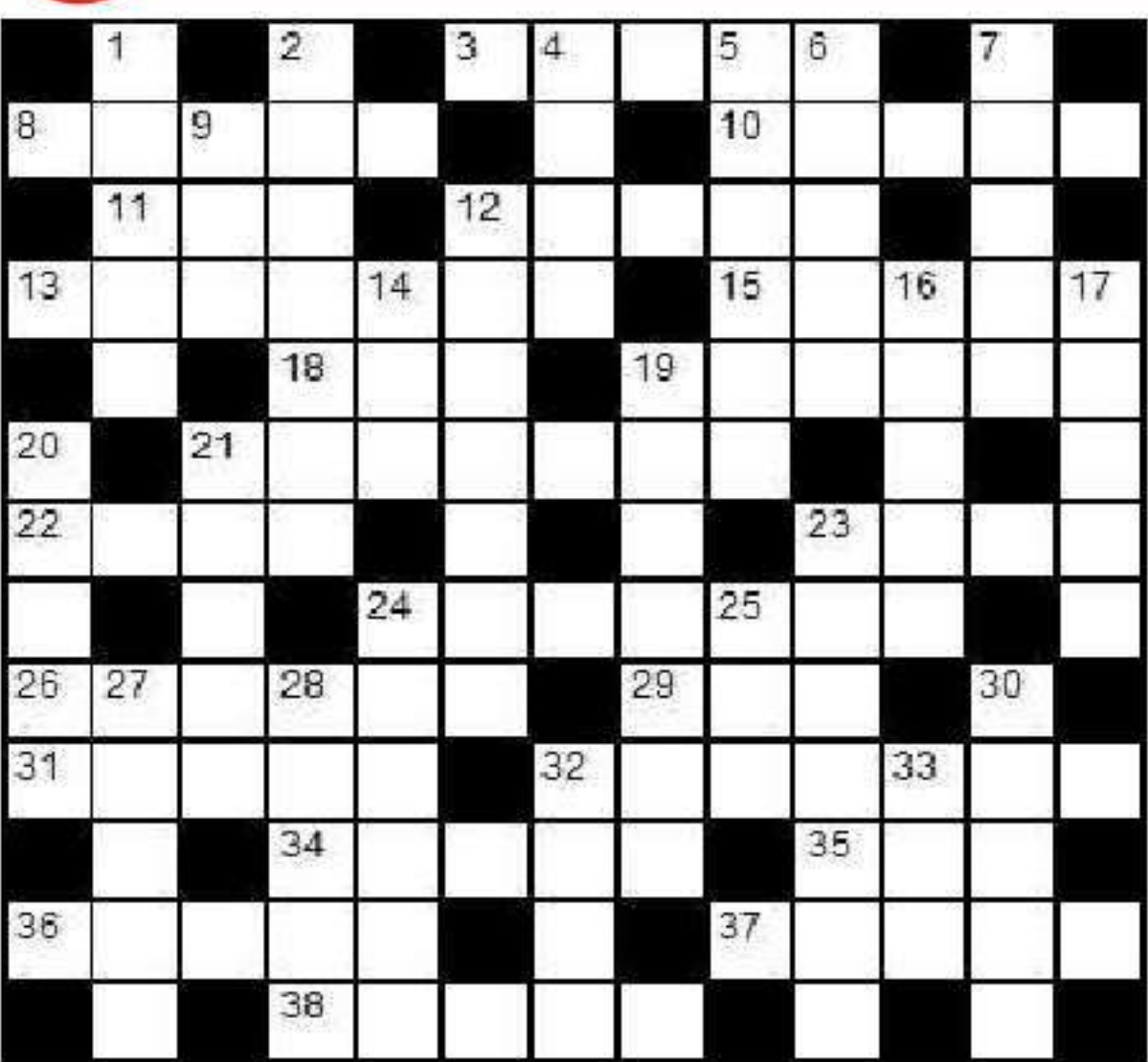
Even such an ordinary dress can be made extraordinary with the help of several accessories. Statement necklace, pretty bag, beautiful earrings, gorgeous scarf or a fashionable belt can all highlight the simplest outfit.

Look for an inspiration and experiment

As for inspiration, look around! Channel the style of a celebrity you look up to or admire or a friend of yours who has an amazing fashion sense, or get inspired by the people you see walking the streets. Whenever you find a great outfit that you wish you had on, save it in your phone so that you can use it as an outfitting inspiration for next time you need to figure out how to dress. Be brave and try something new and experiment because no one looks good wearing something they do not feel comfortable wearing. For outfitting challenges, always keep in mind the event, the place and the people you will be seeing. If in doubt, always go for the fanciest option.

If you need to decide between smart and casual but can't decide which to go for, go for smart. A denim or cargo jacket will always be a great addition to any outfit to give it more structure and make it look fancier.

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**
- Common sense (5)
 - Wed (5)
 - Vast ages (5)
 - Bollywood's Aishwarya ___ Bachchan (3)
 - "Mea ___" (5)
 - Unfeelingly cruel (7)
 - Talk at length (5)
 - Provide crew for (3)
 - Bankrolled (6)
 - Al fresco (4-3)
 - Sacred river of "Kubla Khan" (4)

- Digestive juice (4)
- Failure to act (7)
- Noisier (6)
- Go in Glasgow (3)
- Copy (5)
- Less dirty? (7)
- French school (5)
- Add up (3)
- Greek letter (5)
- Begin and seem likely to continue? (3,2)
- Scythe handle (5)

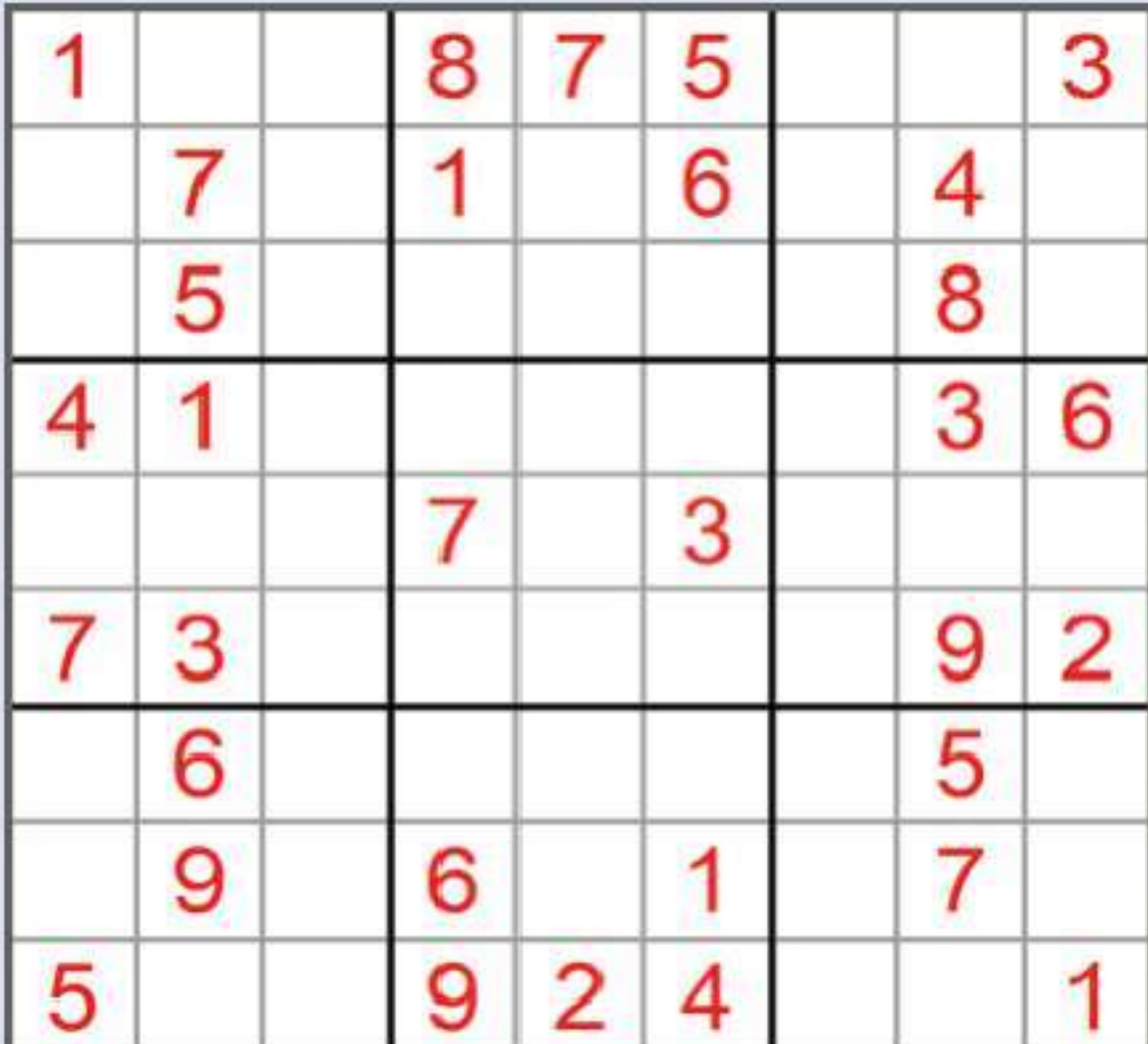
DOWN

- Gains from work (5)
- Win (7)
- "Runa" changes into a local lad? (4)
- Mist, fume or gas (6)
- Long for (5)
- Join together (5)
- Cheer (3)
- More prudent or more shrewd (7)
- West of Hollywood! (3)
- Let in (5)
- Advantages (5)
- Wangle (7)
- Single stem (5)
- Narcotic made from poppy (5)
- Cried like a sheep? (7)
- Plateau in South Central India (6)
- Dubai locale (3)
- Cargo boat - "Roile" anagram? (5)
- Food plans (5)
- Noisome (5)
- Coagulate (4)
- In no manner (3)



Solution to October 3

SUDOKU



Solution to October 3

Stop apologizing for being successful: Shabana Azmi

Veteran actress Shabana Azmi opened her heart in the past about the pressure a woman faces to apologize for her successes in her work life. Her husband, the writer Javed Akhtar, once advised her not to be so hard on herself and to stop apologizing for her achievements.

The actress spoke about this incident in an interview with Simi Garewal that took place in 2000 in Rendezvous with Simi Garewal. Javed Akhtar was present too, which allowed the audience to learn a little bit more about the life and career of Shabana Azmi.

He [Javed] said, "You have to stop apologizing for being successful and asked me if I was feeling guilty about my achievements," Shabana narrated. The actress then adds how this message helped her understand that she, like many women, struggled with constantly needing to prove to her family that her career was not an alternate to her familial duties.

She says that women feel the need to "prove themselves over and over again" in their families' eyes. She explains how Javed told her that women think they need to assure their parents, siblings, partners, and children that their professional achievements and successes do not mean less



devotion to their family. "I didn't realize that I was doing this myself until he mentioned it," Shabana concludes. She realizes now that she has been putting a lot of pressure on herself to succeed both personally and professionally. Her husband's words helped her realize the kind of environment she wanted for her and her family.

Shabana and Javed Akhtar got married in 1984. Prior to this, however, Javed was married to Honey Irani and has two children with her: filmmaker Farhan Akhtar and filmmaker Zoya Akhtar. Shabana and Javed celebrated their 41st wedding anniversary in December 2025.



I am someone who sits down and thinks about how I want to play my cricket and how I want to bat in certain scenarios. And when I'm batting at number five, I won't say there's a fixed template, but there's a little bit of a blueprint in my head as to this is how I'm going to play in ODI cricket. And when it comes to the test, there's something that there's a game plan for. And that for me is most important

- KL Rahul

Sports Nation

Kumkum, Sujeet named first recipients of Jaspal Rana, Raja Randhir Singh awards

NAGOYA

ARCHER Kumkum Mohod and wrestler Sujeet Kalkal have been named the inaugural recipients of the Jaspal Rana Award and Raja Randhir Singh Award respectively by the Indian Olympic Association for their outstanding performances at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games.

The awards have been instituted by the IOA to honour the best female and male sportspersons of the Games and commemorate the legacy of two stalwarts of Indian sport who died earlier this year.

Seventeen-year-old Mohod, making her Asian Games debut, won three medals, including two gold, and played a pivotal role in ending South Korea's long-standing dominance in



women's recurve archery.

IOA president PT Usha hailed Mohod's achievement, saying, "It is fitting that Kumkum is the first recipient of the Jaspal Rana Award, as Jaspal too burst onto the scene as a prodigy at the 1994 Asian Games. Her composure under pressure and her ability to find her best form when her back was to the wall augur extremely

well for Indian Archery.

"India came close to winning a maiden Olympic medal in the sport at the Paris Olympics, and I am convinced that final frontier will be breached at the Los Angeles Olympics."

Sujeet, meanwhile, was named the inaugural recipient of the Raja Randhir Singh Award after winning gold in the men's 65kg



freestyle wrestling category.

Hailing Sujeet's performance, Usha said, "Wrestling is India's sport, and Sujeet's performance will be spoken of for years to come. The gold medal will be celebrated, but his never-say-die attitude and refusal to accept silver have earned him a special place in the hearts of all Indians."

The IOA will felicitate Mohod and Sujeet at a ceremony in the coming days. Mohod, along with Ankita

Bhakat and Kirti, won the women's recurve team gold, ending South Korea's run of seven consecutive Asian Games titles dating back to the 1998 Bangkok Games.

She followed it up with gold in the individual event, ensuring that South Korea's women failed to win a recurve gold at the Asian Games for the first time in the history of the discipline. Her individual gold also secured a quota place for India at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

India U17 men share spoils with Myanmar in first friendly

THANYLIN (MYANMAR)

A spirited fightback saw a goal down India U17 men's national team restore parity and draw 1-1 with Myanmar in the first friendly match at the StarCity Sports Club in Thanlyin, Myanmar, on Sunday.

The hosts opened the scoreline through Aung Myat Thar in the 42nd minute, before the Blue Colts drew level from Dallalmuon Gangte's penalty in the 73rd minute.

After the initial enthusiasm and exuberance displayed by both sets of very eager boys, it was Myanmar who took the lead much against the run of play. Allowed a deep run



from the top of the box, Aung Myat Thar's first attempt was blocked by defender Abhishek Kumar Mondal.

But the ball rolled onto his path and the Myanmar striker produced a firm, low right-footer which squeezed between the outstretched legs of goalkeeper Maroof Shafi.

In fact, till then Shafi had ruled the 18-yard box effectively and never allowed the Myanmar strikers any liberties. Except for a couple of shots skimming the

crossbar, they did little to trouble the goalkeeper.

But just a minute after trailing, Mehraruddin Wadoo's side almost restored parity when the tall striker Hrishikesh Charan Manavathi outjumped everyone and headed into the centre a lob from Maldino Singh Yumnam from the right but goalkeeper Wai Yan Htet did well to turn it over the bar as Myanmar kept their lead at the break.

After resumption, the Blue Colts showed a lot of urgency and launched a series of attacks in search of the equaliser. But the deep-lying Myanmar defence stood firm. Skipper Gangte did a fine job in midfield.

One Asia, one last celebration: Aichi-Nagoya bids farewell

NAGOYA

A dazzling blend of light, music and Japanese culture brought the curtains down on the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games at the Mizuho Park Athletic Stadium on Sunday, ending more than two weeks of intense competition that produced over 350 records, including more than 50 world records.

The 90-minute closing ceremony featured vibrant displays of Japanese culture and hospitality, with athletes from 45 Asian countries joining the celebrations. The Games, however, had been preceded by criticism over logistical troubles and alleged mismanagement in the build-up.

India finished fourth on the medal table with 85 medals — 21 gold, 27 silver and 37 bronze — 21 fewer than its tally at Hangzhou. China topped the table for a record 12th consecutive edition with 341



medals, including 169 gold, 89 silver and 83 bronze. Host Japan finished second with 269 medals — 83 gold, 95 silver and 91 bronze — while South Korea was third with 39 gold, 43 silver and 68 bronze.

Trap shooter Neeru Dhandu, who won two gold medals and a silver, led the Indian contingent. Around 30 Indian athletes and officials, dressed in white and blue kits, joined the parade waving the Tricolour. Olympic Council of Asia president Sheikh Joan Bin Hamad

Al Thani officially declared the Games closed in the presence of Japan's Crown Prince and Crown Princess Akishino. "We close these Games, but we raise the bar for Asian sport," he said. "The flame may be extinguished, but the hopes it has ignited will continue to burn brightly across our continent."

He highlighted the remarkable comebacks, last-second victories, near-misses, emerging teenage stars and seasoned champions, along with athletes overcoming

adversity and injury and displays of sportsmanship. He said more than 350 records, including over 50 world records, had been broken — a record for the Asian Games.

The ceremony's "One Asia" theme was reflected in a hexagonal central stage decorated with lanterns. Bon-odori dance and Nagoya's popular "Matsuken Samba II" showcased Japanese culture, followed by laser displays, music and performances by artists from the Nagoya School of Music and Dance.



Kuldeep picked seven scalps in the three-match series

ODI series win over Windies

Kuldeep wins Impact Player of the Series award

NEW CHANDIGARH: Left-arm wrist-spinner Kuldeep Yadav was named the winner of 'Impact Player of the Series' award following India's 2-1 ODI series victory over the West Indies. He earned high praise from team physiotherapist Yogesh Parmar for putting his body on the line and achieving major milestones throughout the leg. Kuldeep emerged as the leading wicket-taker in the three-match series by picking seven scalps, including a four-wicket haul in Thiruvananthapuram. He also became the fastest Indian spinner to cross the 200-wicket milestone in men's ODIs. "First of all, congratulations for winning the series. The award goes to someone who has consistently performed throughout the series. He has also got 200 wickets in ODI format. So that's another achievement and he is also the highest wicket taker for this series. "As we discussed, he has always stood up and performed exceptionally well and he has always put his body on the line and this award goes to Kuldeep Yadav," Parmar said in a video posted on BCCI's social media accounts on Sunday. Accepting the honour, Kuldeep credited senior batters — captain Shubman Gill, Virat Kohli, wicketkeeper-batter KL Rahul, and Rohit Sharma for setting up matches with the bat, while reflecting on the preparatory camp in Thiruvananthapuram helping him hit peak rhythm ahead of the series.

HPRC Draw 10-10 with US Club in Kentucky Polo Thriller

Paris, Kentucky: The Hyderabad Polo and Riding Club (HPRC), representing India, drew 10-10 with Commonwealth Polo Club of the United States in the Kentucky leg of its 2026 international tour at Paris, Kentucky, on Saturday night.

The arena polo final, played under lights, remained closely contested through four chukkers and overtime, with neither side able to establish a decisive advantage.

Chaitania Kumar, president of HPRC, and Arsalan Khan scored four goals each for India, while Saif Attari added two.

India fielded a three-man team of Kumar, Khan and Attari, riding horses provided by the host club. The match was played at Commonwealth Polo Club's arena, about 20 minutes from Lexington, in the heart of Kentucky's thoroughbred country. National flags of India and the US were carried into the arena before the opening chucker.

"That was as hard a game of arena polo as any of us have played," Kumar said, describing the contest as neck and neck throughout. He thanked Commonwealth Polo Club for providing its horses, arena and hospitality.

Result

USA (Commonwealth Polo Club) 10, India (HPRC) 10. Scorers for India: Chaitania Kumar 4, Arsalan Khan 4, Saif Attari 2.



'Will bring laws against love, land jihad in 6 months'

Talking about the Uniform Civil Code, Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari said West Bengal will follow Uttarakhand and Gujarat in implementing them

KOLKATA

WEST Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Sunday said his government will bring stringent laws against "love jihad" and "land jihad" in six months, and implement a Uniform Civil Code in the state like Uttarakhand and Gujarat. Addressing an event here to mark the birth centenary of Vishva Hindu Parishad's (VHP) former president Ashok Singhal, he said the BJP government in the state would function in accordance with the Con-



stitution, but would not tolerate attacks on Indian culture, tradition and places of worship. "This government will not allow any anti-national activity here," he said and urged people to remain united and

vigilant against "divisive forces". Adhikari said, "You can rest assured that the government will function in accordance with the Constitution. But it will not allow any attack on Indian culture, Sanatani traditions, temples and monasteries, and our heritage that spiritual icons Vivekananda and Mahaprabhu Sri Chaitanya have propounded."

Talking about the Uniform Civil Code, the chief minister said West Bengal would follow Uttarakhand and Gujarat in implementing a Uniform Civil Code. "Give us six

months, will also bring stringent laws against love and land jihad," he told the gathering.

The West Bengal government has constituted a high-level committee headed by former Supreme Court judge Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai to examine a draft Uniform Civil Code (UCC) for the state.

According to a government notification, the West Bengal UCC Bill aims to standardise civil laws across all communities on matters concerning marriage, divorce, inheritance and adoption.

The UCC was one of the key poll promises of the BJP in the 2026 Assembly elections. Talking about the proposed religious tourism circuit, Adhikari said the project would be completed in two years with Rs 1,000 crore earmarked for it. "We need your suggestions and your co-operation," he told the gathering.

Attacking the previous TMC dispensation, Adhikari said there were several causes for its downfall, but "repeated hurt to Hindu sentiments, organisations, deities and traditions" were the foremost reasons.

INDIA bloc to protest outside Delhi EC office

NEW DELHI: The Delhi units of INDIA bloc parties will hold a joint protest outside the Delhi Election Commission office on Wednesday against the SIR and demand the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The decision was taken at a meeting attended by representatives of the Congress, Communist Party of India (CPI), Communist Party of India (Marxist), Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD), Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) and Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP), among others, according to a statement issued by the Delhi Congress on Sunday.



Delhi Congress general secretary Anil Bhardwaj said the parties had decided to jointly oppose what they termed a "flawed" SIR process and seek its immediate repeal. "The voter list is the foundation of democracy. If any process is adopted that could potentially remove voters' names or impact their rights, the INDIA Alliance will not accept it at any cost," Bhardwaj said in the statement.



9 Indian fishermen held by Lankan navy

COLOMBO: The Sri Lanka Navy has arrested nine Indian fishermen and seized their trawler for allegedly poaching in its territorial waters, according to an official statement. The fishermen were arrested on Saturday for having crossed the International Maritime Boundary Line in Sri Lankan waters south of Delft Island, Jaffna, the island nation's navy said in a statement. "During the operation, one Indian fishing trawler was seized, while nine Indian fishermen on board were taken into custody by SLNS Samudura," it said. Those apprehended were taken to Kankesanthurai Harbour and will be handed to the Department of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources for further legal proceedings.

EC skips full Commission visits to poll-bound states

The term of the 403-member Uttar Pradesh assembly ends on May 22 next year, the terms of the 60-member Manipur, 40-member Goa, 117-member Punjab and 70-member Uttarakhand assemblies end on different dates in March, 2027

NEW DELHI

SENIOR Election Commission officials led by deputy election commissioners will start visiting the five poll-bound states from this week to oversee election preparedness at the field level.

Functionaries said teams from the EC



will visit Goa this week, followed by Uttarakhand next week. The EC officials will also visit Punjab and then Manipur in the coming weeks.

There is no word yet on when EC officials will visit Uttar Pradesh.

Usually, the 'full Commission' comprising the chief election commissioner and fellow commissioners visits poll-bound states ahead of announcement of election schedule.

While the term of the 403-member Uttar Pradesh assembly ends on May 22 next year, the terms of 60-member

Manipur, 40-member Goa, 117-member Punjab and 70-member Uttarakhand assemblies end on different dates in March, 2027.

Provisions of The Representation of the People Act, 1950 allows EC to hold polls 'earlier than six months before the term expires'. As part of poll preparation, Uttar Pradesh and Goa have initiated 'first-level checks' (FLCs) on electronic voting machines and paper trail units to be used in polling.

During FLCs, engineers from BEL and ECIL, the two PSUs that manufacture the equipment, check the electronic voting machines and paper trail machines for mechanical flaws. Faulty machines are returned to the manufacturers for repair or replacement.

A mock poll is also held to check the two machines in the presence of representatives of political parties.

IIT-Delhi PhD student dies after 45-day treatment

FIR lodged following Supreme Court directions

NEW DELHI: An FIR has been registered in connection with the death of a 40-year-old PhD student of the IIT-Delhi, who was found unconscious and injured at his rented accommodation in Munirka in August, police said on Sunday.

The FIR under section 108 (abetment of suicide) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) was lodged at the Kishangarh police station on October 4 following directions from the Supreme Court and a complaint received from the security officer of the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), they said. The man was found in an unconscious and injured condition inside his rented house in Munirka village on August 18, a senior police officer said. The door was locked from inside and



neighbours broke it open. Police immediately took him to the AIIMS Trauma Centre. He remained under medical care for more than 45 days before succumbing to his injuries at the hospital on October 3, police said. Police clarified that the incident did not occur inside the IIT-Delhi campus. During the proceedings, neither family members nor witnesses raised any suspicion or allegation against any person, police said.



Flydubai co-pilot studied in Australia, probe launched

DUBAI: Following reports that Hamam al-Hammami, the Omani co-pilot behind the September 30 terrorist attack aboard Flydubai Flight FZ1073 from Dubai to Tel Aviv, had been granted Australian student visa in 2014, authorities in Canberra have initiated an inquiry, according to The Times of Israel. "The Victorian Joint Counter Terrorism Team (VIC JCTT), comprising the AFP, Victoria Police and ASIO, can confirm it is investigating the man's links to Australia," an Australian Federal Police spokesperson stated, according to The Times of Israel, which cited a report from The Guardian.



"India doesn't need to copy the US model, but it can take inspiration from it and expedite efforts to build a trusted AI ecosystem that should cover testing AI systems before deployment, independent audits, reporting serious problems, and naming people responsible for AI-related risks."
-Soumen Mandal,
Principal Analyst, Counterpoint Research

Eight-week market slide raises caution ahead of RBI policy

Investors track crude, inflation, rupee and foreign flows as volatility stays elevated

Weekly Snapshot

- **FII's offloaded Rs34,966.07-cr; DIIs purchased Rs33,455.30-cr in equities**
- **Eroded nearly Rs15L-cr from the combined market valuation of BSE-listed firms**

C KUTUMBA RAO

SPOOKED by elevated international crude oil prices amid renewed tensions in the Middle East, rising global bond yields, persistent foreign fund outflows and a weakening rupee; equity markets extended their losing streak to the eighth consecutive week, marking the longest weekly decline in 25 years and surpassing the streaks seen during the 2020 Covid-19 crash and the 2008 global financial crisis.

For the week, the Sensex plunged 1,986.04 points, or 2.68 per cent, to 71,909.70, while the Nifty tumbled 718.55 points, or 3.10 per cent, to 22,421.95. Volatility expanded sharply alongside the decline in the benchmark indices. The Nifty Midcap 100 index declined 3.5 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 index extended its losing streak for the fourth consecutive week, declining 3.3 per cent. FIIs accelerated their selling during the week, extending their selling streak to

the sixth consecutive week, offloading equities worth Rs34,966.07 crore. Meanwhile, DIIs continued to provide support, purchasing equities worth Rs33,455.30 crore during the week.

The market sell-off eroded nearly Rs15 lakh crore from the combined market value of BSE-listed companies during the week. After remaining rangebound during the first three days, the Indian rupee came under pressure on Thursday and moved closer to its record low of 96.96 to close at 96.32. During the week, the rupee traded in a range of 95.74-96.32 against the greenback.

India Manufacturing PMI rose to 55.1 in September from 52.8 in August, the strongest improvement in the health of the sector for seven months. However, August CPI inflation increased to 4.82 per cent, moving further above the RBI's 4 per cent target and adding to concerns over the inflation outlook. In the last meeting, the RBI has retained the repo rate at 5.25 per cent with a neutral stance and projected FY27 GDP growth at 6.7 per cent.

The RBI Monetary Policy Committee is scheduled to meet from October 5-7, with the policy decision due on October 7. This event may keep interest-rate-sensitive pockets and the broader market somewhat cautious



The persistent energy shock also stalled the multi-year global disinflation process, while higher diesel, jet fuel and natural gas prices put pressure on household savings and trade balances in energy-importing countries

ahead of the announcement and could contribute to elevated intra-day volatility around the policy outcome. Closely track the RBI's assessment of inflation, crude oil, the rupee and global financial conditions.

Market expectations have increasingly factored in the possibility of a 25-basis-point rate hike, although a hawkish hold also remains possible if the RBI prefers to assess incoming data. In the near term, the direction of crude oil, US bond yields and foreign flows will remain critical. Attention will also centre on FOMC minutes and a run of Fed speeches for further clarity on the central bank's reaction to recent data.

The geopolitical crisis in

the Middle East had entered its eighth month and resulted in severe disruptions to global commodity supplies, with Brent crude staying above \$100 a barrel. The persistent energy shock also stalled the multi-year global disinflation process, while higher diesel, jet fuel and natural gas prices put pressure on household savings and trade balances in energy-importing countries.

However, until oil prices and global yields moderate, the market is likely to remain sensitive to global cues and policy signals. Q2 earnings season, changing market conditions and shifting risks across global markets make it important for investors to stay agile with their portfolio and asset allocation.

Quote of the week:
Markets change continuously and so must you. What worked last year, last month, or even last week may very well not work today. You must constantly test your methods to see if they are valid. You must consistently evaluate your thinking and assumptions to see if they still apply. Do not let your greed get the better of your judgment

FUTURES & OPTIONS / SECTOR WATCH

Sustained selling pressure continued during the monthly settlement week amid elevated crude oil prices and persistent global uncertainties. Nifty declined more than 3 per cent on a weekly basis while Bank Nifty outperformed with a

relatively moderate decline of over 2 per cent. The Nifty traded in a wide 862.95-point range before some recovery emerged from the lows. In the options segment, strong Call open interest for Nifty was observed at the 22,700 and 22,800 levels while major Put open interest was concentrated at the 22,300 and 22,000 levels. For Bank Nifty, significant Call open interest was seen at 55,000 level whereas notable Put open interest was also placed at the 54,000 level. Implied volatility (IV) for Nifty's Call options settled at 12.49 per cent while Put options concluded at 13.87 per cent. The India VIX, a key indicator of market volatility concluded the week at 13.49 per cent. The Put-Call Ratio Open Interest (PCR OI) stood at 1.04 for the week. Nifty rollovers

declined to 74.29 per cent from 77.39 per cent last month and remained below the three-month average of 76.48 per cent indicating relatively weaker rollover activity. Bank Nifty future rollovers were broadly stable at 79.31 per cent compared to 79.19 per cent last month and remained above the three-month average of 77.55 per cent. However, the index is trading below its 55,700-55,800 rollover zone making 55,800 a key resistance level. Re-sistance to the Nifty is expected at 22,600 and 22,800, while supports are placed at 22,200 and 22,000. The near-over-sold technical setup makes aggressive fresh shorts susceptible to a sharp counter-trend rebound. With the RBI policy decision on October 7 adding an event-risk

dimension to an already fragile technical setup, volatility may remain elevated. The preferred approach for the week ahead is to remain stock-specific, light on leverage and disciplined with risk, while allowing the Nifty's behaviour around its 200-week MA to establish whether the anticipated technical rebound can develop into a more meaningful recovery.

Stocks looking good are Enrin (Siemens Energy), Kotak Bank, HDFC Bank, Power India (Hitachi Energy), Mankind and Sona Comstar. Stocks looking weak are Adani Energy, Godfrey Phillips, Tata Power, Torrent Pharma, Patanjali and Vedanta.

(The author is a senior market analyst and former vice-chairman, Andhra Pradesh State Planning Board)

Bhavish pledges 4.32% Ola Electric stake for rights issue

BENGALURU

OLA Electric Chairman and Managing Director Bhavish Aggarwal has pledged a 4.32 per cent stake in the company to participate in its rights issue, which was approved by the company's Board on September 28. In a statement to the stock exchanges on Sunday, the company said, "Ola Electric promoter Bhavish Aggarwal has pledged a 4.32 per cent stake in the company to participate in the rights issue approved by the Board, as disclosed in the Draft Letter

of Offer filed on September 28 2026. This pledge is solely to fund his subscription to the issue, and there are no other pledges to his securities currently; no shares are being sold. The promoter will invest alongside all other shareholders on the same terms." As shown in filings made to the exchanges by the promoter under SAST regulations, 20 crore shares held by Aggarwal are being pledged against non-convertible debentures issued by Krutrim Data Centre Private Limited, in favour of CTL Trusteeship Limited.

GST Council may clear sweeping compliance reforms

E-commerce sellers, genuine buyers and MSMEs likely to get relief from proposed changes

NEW DELHI

THE GST Council is likely to consider sweeping process reforms on Wednesday to make tax compliance easier for businesses, including allowing small e-commerce sellers to use platform warehouses for GST registration, protecting genuine buyers' input tax credit and reducing low-value litigation, sources said.

The proposals, part of the GST 2.0 process reforms, seek to simplify registration and return filing, make goods movement more predictable and reduce disputes between taxpayers and the



tax department.

One of the proposals seeks to allow small sellers using e-commerce platforms to treat the platform's warehouse as their registered place of business in states where they do not have their own premises. A seller would need a genuine presence in one state, where physical verification and Aadhaar authentication would be completed, and registrations in other states

could be obtained with the consent of the e-commerce platform without further tax-officer involvement.

The move could enable around 9.5 lakh small sellers to access the national market without establishing physical offices in every state where their goods are stored, while creating greater tax parity across competing e-commerce business models, sources said.

The Council may also consider a proposal to protect input tax credit of genuine buyers even if an upstream supplier defaults on tax payment. The recovery action in such cases

would instead be directed at the defaulting seller.

The proposal seeks to address a major source of GST litigation and business uncertainty, particularly for companies purchasing from small and new vendors.

FEWER LOW-VALUE DISPUTES

To reduce litigation and administrative burden, the Council is likely to consider a proposal to bar issuance of GST notices where the tax demand is below Rs 10,000. Such cases account for about 20 per cent of all cases by number but involve a negligible amount of tax, according to the proposal.

Jio Platforms may hit market at \$146 bn valuation

NEW DELHI

JIO Platforms is likely to list by the end of October at an enterprise valuation of USD 143-146 billion, or more than Rs 12 lakh crore, sources tracking the development said.

The IPO is expected to be India's largest public offer, with the issue size estimated at around USD 3.8 billion.

The company has completed overseas roadshows in the US, UK, Dubai, Hong Kong and Singapore and is expected to file final papers

with market regulator SEBI in the week starting October 12, banking sources said.

Jio Platforms is also expected to conduct an India roadshow after filing the red herring prospectus. An anchor round could begin before Dussehra, with the issue likely to open after Dussehra and before October 23.

SEBI issued its final observations on August 28. Jio Platforms had filed its draft IPO papers in June and plans to issue up to 27 crore fresh equity shares, or about 2.9% of its post-issue equity base.

Asset allocation is the foundation of a portfolio

DECIDE THE MIX OF EQUITY, DEBT AND GOLD BEFORE SELECTING INDIVIDUAL INVESTMENTS

K.NARESH KUMAR

WHEN planning to build a portfolio, the usual questions include which assets to pick, which mutual funds (MF) to add and what about gold allocation, etc. But the portfolio construction begins somewhere else. A good portfolio isn't about a collection of good investments. It's a combination of assets designed around an investor's goals, time horizon, risk capacity and future cashflow requirements. The objective is not to maximize returns at any cost but to achieve required financial outcomes without taking untoward risks.

The first step in portfolio is to understand the investor. The critical questions include what's the money required for, when will it be needed, how much loss can the investor financially withstand, how much volatility can the investor emotionally tolerate and what other assets, liabilities and sources of income does the investor already have? The answers determine the portfolio.

A 30-year-old investing

for retirement 25 years away can accommodate considerably more equity than someone who needs the money to fund a child's education three years from now. Similarly, someone with a stable pension and substantial financial assets may be able to take more investment risk than someone dependent entirely on the portfolio for current expenses.

But that doesn't immediately assign the proportion of risk assets to be included in a portfolio. This is why a portfolio cannot be designed simply by assigning an investor a label such as "conservative", "moderate" or "aggressive". Probably each need could turn into multiple risk profiles for the same investor and change their risk profile at different periods of time.

An aggressive investor could turn into conservative during periods of income uncertainty or job loss. However, by separating allocations according to the time horizon of the requirement could help prevent a common mistake putting the entire portfolio into a single asset without considering the



different requirements.

Once the objectives and time horizons are understood, the next question is asset allocation. It serves as the foundation. For example, a long-term moderate-growth portfolio might begin with something like 60 per cent equity, 30 per cent debt and 10 per cent gold. A more aggressive long-term investor might have 75 per cent equity, 15 per cent debt and 10 per cent gold.

These are not universal prescriptions. The appropriate allocation depends on the investor's circumstances. The important point is that the

allocation should be decided before selecting individual funds or securities. Once the asset allocation has been decided, the next step is to determine what goes inside each asset class.

A portfolio might include large-cap or broad-market exposure, diversified active funds, small-, mid-cap exposure and international equities too. But owning more funds does not necessarily mean having more diversification. Five mutual funds can collectively own many of the same companies. The investor may believe that the portfolio is diversified when

it is concentrated in the same underlying businesses and sectors. Don't confuse diversification with the number of investments.

It's not just equity but each asset has a role. Money required at a specific future date should not automatically be exposed to the same risks as long-term capital. While it seems like boring, debt can provide capital stability, liquidity, predictability and counterweight to portfolio volatility. Depending on the investor's needs, the debt allocation could include deposits, government securities, high-quality bonds, target-maturity products, EPF, PPF and other suitable instruments. But even within debt, risks differ. Credit risk, interest-rate risk and liquidity risk need to be considered.

Gold can play a useful role in a portfolio because its return drivers can differ from those of equities and bonds. But gold should not simply be added because its recent performance has been strong. Gold should've a defined purpose beforehand, primarily as a diversifier and potential hedge against infla-

tionary, currency and other geopolitical crisis. For many investors, a relatively modest allocation may be sufficient.

Perhaps the most overlooked aspect of portfolio construction is the investor's total balance sheet. Portfolio construction should consider financial assets, real assets, liabilities and future income together. Looking only at the financial portfolio could give a very different picture from looking at the investor's entire economic position.

Remember that an investor's willingness to take risk and ability to take risk are not the same thing. Someone may say they are comfortable with a 30 per cent decline in their portfolio. But if they need the money next year, they may not have the financial capacity to tolerate that decline.

Another investor may dislike market volatility but have a stable income, substantial surplus assets and a 20-year horizon. Their financial capacity may be high even though their emotional tolerance is lower. So, risk capacity is different from risk-tolerance, and a sensible portfolio must reconcile

both.

In simple terms, risk tolerance tells us how much volatility an investor can emotionally live with. Risk capacity tells us how much risk the investor can financially afford. The portfolio should respect the more restrictive of the two.

Build the portfolio only after deciding the allocation. The sequence begins with goals, time horizon, risk, asset allocation then portfolio construction and product/investment selection. But, the usual mistake is to reverse this process with deciding an investment avenue and then trying to suit to the need or goal. This should be avoided.

Building a portfolio is only the beginning. Investors need rules for what happens afterwards. Rebalancing brings the portfolio back toward its intended risk level. Rebalancing does not always require selling. New investments can be directed toward underweight assets, gradually bringing the portfolio back toward its target allocation.

An investment or a fund needn't necessarily be re-

placed simply because it underperformed for one year. There should be predefined reasons for replacement—such as persistent deterioration, change in mandate, significant process changes or other material concerns. Arguably, the most important portfolio rule may be the one written before a market crash. Investors often discover their true risk tolerance only after the portfolio has fallen sharply.

A good investment plan therefore specifies in advance what will happen when markets fall 10 per cent, 20 per cent or 30 per cent. The purpose of portfolio construction is not to predict which asset will perform best next year. It is to create a structure that can survive different economic environments, participate in long-term growth, provide liquidity when required and remain aligned with the investor's goals.

(The author is a partner with "Wealocity Analytics", a SEBI registered Research Analyst and could be reached at info@wealocityanalytics.com)





Ravi Teja releases Sree Vishnu's energetic track from 'Comrade Kalyan'

Mass Maharaja Ravi Teja has released the title track of Telugu movie, Comrade Kalyan starring Sree Vishnu. The song has been garnering good responses on social media ever since its release.

Set to the peppy composition by Vijay Bulganin, the track features Sree Vishnu as a fun-filled comrade along with an energetic performance by Rahul Sipligunj. The lyrics, penned by Bhaskarabhatla, depict the light-hearted nature of the protagonist, with the song being in sync with the film's theme.

Presented by Kona Venkat and produced by Venkata Krishna Karnati and Seetha Karnati under the Skanda Vahana Motion Pictures LLP banner, Comrade Kalyan is set to release worldwide on 9th October.

Directed by Janakiram Marella, the film combines elements of historical fiction, drama, romance and has been met with positive responses following the glimpse, teaser, and songs' release.

The film stars Radhika Sarathkumar, Shine Tom Chacko, and Upendra Limaye alongside Sree Vishnu. Besides composing music, Vijay Bulganin has also scored the track, while Sai Sriram has been the cinematographer and Chota K. Prasad the editor. The team hopes the film's unique blend of drama and romance will strike a chord with viewers.

'Least Eligible Bachelor' trailer promises a fun-filled entertainer

A trailer of Least Eligible Bachelor was released by the makers recently, highlighting a fun-filled entertainer. The movie stars Viva Harsha in the lead role and is directed by Babu Degala. The film is scheduled to premiere on ETV Win on 9th October.

The trailer opens up with an interesting comic setup where Harsha's father approaches girls to consider his son as a prospective groom despite Harsha's character not being very interested in love. From there on the promo only moves on to more comedy, quirky situations and entertaining moments. Harsha's comic timing stands out as one of the main attractions while his hyperactive character adds more spice to the narration. Jeevan Kumar, Aishwarya Holakkal and Sravya Chowdary are also part of the story. Chavan, Sridhar Chenni and Deepak Mustyala have produced the film while Raj Suhas and Pramadeswi V have been appointed as creative producers. Ajay Arasada has scored music while Shakti Aravind has been the cinematographer for the venture. Johnny Shaik has been the production designer, Likhith Lee the editor, Sai Pravalika the costume designer and PVG Viswanath the line producer.



Sharwa's 'Bhogi' teaser generates immense hype

The first look poster and teaser of 'Bhogi', featuring Charming Star Sharwa, created an exponential buzz for the upcoming film. The action-pacy drama is directed by Sampath Nandi.

For this film, a massive transformation was required for actor Sharwa, who is seen in the role of Ganga, a rugged labourer from the village. His impactful dialogues, intensity on the screen and raw power in the expressions have already left the audience

wanting more. He delivers his dialogue with an intimidating manner in the concluding segment of the teaser, as he pronounces his warning to the antagonists.

Besides showcasing the rustic environment, the teaser also introduces Boggula Gutta with a folk-style narration, while Anupama Parameswaran's character narrates the development that led to Kammari Ganga's disappearance by the hands of the 'Palagallu'. A certain devotional ritual is believed to hold the key to restoring the lost tradition of the village. Anupama Parameswaran makes a rustic

Singeetham Srinivasa Rao: The filmmaker who never stopped dreaming

SUHAS SISTU

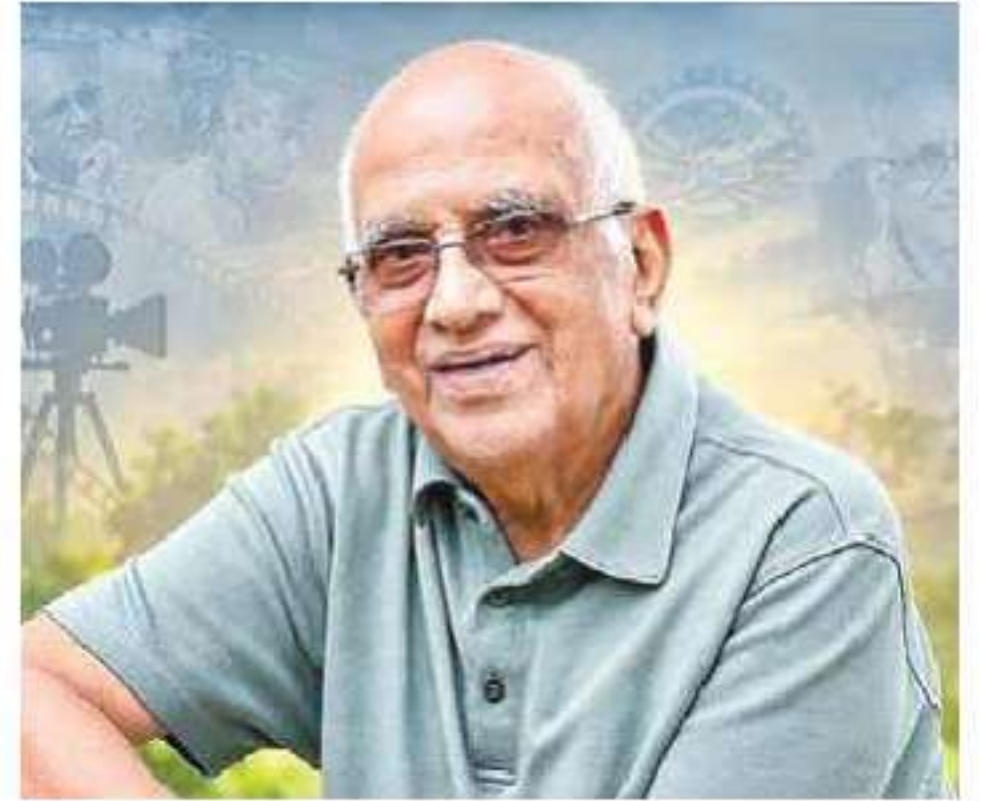
The work of legendary filmmaker Singeetham Srinivasa Rao has always been characterised by an insatiable need to explore, an inquisitive mind and a desire to experiment. At 94 years old, he still had time for writing stories for the screen. With his passing away on October 3, 2026 in Chennai, an era of Indian cinema came to an end. But his works and thoughts will continue to inspire younger generations of filmmakers.

Right after the news of his death broke out, director-producer Nag Ashwin shared a screenshot of a message, received by Rao himself on September 5, 2026. It was a simple note, which clearly demonstrates that till the very end he remained passionate about cinema and its people.

Over his seven-decade-long career, Rao has worked in different languages and genres. His films Pushpak, Aditya 369, Bhairava Dweepam, Mayuri, Apoorva Sagotharargal, Michael Madana Kama Rajan and Raaja Paarvai are recognised as masterclasses on approaching the well-known concepts from an unexpected angle. For Rao, filmmaking has always been a constant search and a challenge. In one of the interviews, he noted that his films are mostly riddles, the solutions to which he finds while shooting them. Thinking about a film as a serious project, which will following a precise scheme did not sit well with him. This approach has consistently shown its results, as it was the case with the science fiction film, Pushpak, which was mostly silent and did not have any songs. While commenting on the curious experiment, he simply said that the reason for it was "Why not?".

Rao's creative journey took a particularly interesting turn recently, as he got a chance to rework one of his own ideas, which he had almost forgotten about. Singeetham, the musical fantasy-drama film, which was planned to be shot in an unusual format, hit the screens almost 40 years after its initial conception. Set in the fictional village of Kuberaipuram, the film tells the story of ecological catastrophe, which was the result of humans' appearance, while Dimple Hayathi is another leading lady in this film, which also stars a host of famous actors.

Kishor Kumar captures the ethos of the time and place perfectly with his camera, while Bheems Ceciroleo's earthy composition adds to the film's dramatic impact. Bhogi produced by KK Radhamohan of Sri Sathya Sai Arts and presented by Lakshmi Radhamohan is currently in the midst of its shooting schedule.



reckless behaviour. Rao surprised everyone by suggesting that in the film, all the dialogues would be presented in the form of songs. Despite some producers' unwillingness to take on the project, Nag Ashwin, along with Swapna and Priyanka Dutt, saw the potential in the unusual concept.

Despite multiple health issues, which prevented regular filming sessions, Rao remained in touch with the young team of the film, headed by Sankalp Gora. The film was eventually released and became a great success, as it provided the viewers with an unforgettable experience.

His contribution to the film industry has had a lasting effect, not only in the works of his mentees. Rao has been working with some of the biggest names in Indian cinema. He started as an assistant director for legendary KV Reddy on the film Mayabazar. Decades later, Nag Ashwin asked him for advice while working on the film Mahanati. His input allowed for creating one of the most memorable scenes of the film, which depicted the events from the shooting of Mayabazar.

Many contemporary filmmakers have recognised Rao for his contribution to the development of Indian cinema. Hanu-Man director Prasanth Varma, who was mentored by him at the beginning of his career, described him as the "Indian Steven Spielberg" of the era. Vivek Athreya also fondly remembers the collaboration with the mastermind, while Mohana Krishna Indraganti and Venkatesh Maha highlight Rao's unique sense of humour and attention to detail.

Singeetham Srinivasa Rao always saw cinema as a hobby. He actively participated in the process of making films, simply because he enjoyed the experience. He even compared it to a holiday. This philosophy has allowed him to not only achieve much success within the industry but also to continuously seek new challenges. The work of Singeetham Srinivasa Rao has consistently broken the mould and redefined the rules. Srinivasa Rao's greatest legacy is the example he has set for his students, collaborators, and future filmmakers. No matter what the task is, no matter how seemingly impossible the project might seem, there is always a way to achieve the desired result. One must only have the desire and the courage to pursue their dreams.



Venkaiah Naidu launches book during 'International Ink Bound 2.0'

The second edition of International Ink Bound 2.0, organized by Kasturi Vijaya Publishers, was held in Prasad Labs on Saturday evening. The literary meet, which witnessed the participation of prominent personalities of the fields of literature, cinema and public life, was chaired by publisher and founder Pamarthi Sudheer Pamireddy.

Former Vice President Muppavarapu Venkaiah Naidu, actor-writer Tanikella Bharani and former Rajya Sabha member Yarlagadda Lakshmi Prasad were among the chief guests who attended the programme.

One of the highlights of the evening was the launch of Screenplay Master Sukumar written by Dr. Praveen Yajjala. The book which traces the journey of filmmaker Sukumar was unveiled by Venkaiah Naidu

who also launched the Telugu, Hindi and English editions of the book. He also launched writer Vanguri Chittan Raj's Avemaina Gnapakala? Marchipovadanika? 'Amamma Kathala Khajana', an anthology of 48 stories by different writers is also launched in the event.

Speaking on the occasion, Venkaiah Naidu said books are vital as they help preserve memories, traditions, language and cultural identity. He also said cinema should be a mix of entertainment and knowledge and commended the effort in capturing Sukumar's contribution to filmmaking.

Tanikella Bharani paid rich tributes to the efforts of Sudheer Pamireddy's family, which has been in the field of literature and publishing. He also recalled Dr Praveen Yajjala's earlier contribution to Na Mithunam.

'Ala Sendravanka' from 'Crazy Kalyanam' gets a grand launch

The makers of Crazy Kalyanam launched the lyrical song Ala Sendravanka at Voxsen University in Hyderabad, where students turned up in numbers and helped create a festive mood. Actor Akhil Uddemari, who plays the second lead role in Raj Weds Rambai, joined in the revelry and loosened up with some foot-tapping moves and interaction with the students.

Set to music composed by Suresh Bobbili, Ala Sendravanka is a melodious

composition with soulful lyrics by the celebrated writer Goreti Venkanna. Singer Anurag Kulkarni has lent his voice to the track.

Akhil Uddemari said at the event that Crazy Kalyanam will find resonance with the youth as well as families and that he was confident the song would strike a chord with listeners. He also spoke about his excitement and the response to his upcoming project.

VK Naresh, Anupama Parameswaran, Tharun



Bhascker and Akhil Uddemari starrer Crazy Kalyanam, helmed by Badrapa Gajula, is being produced by Boosam Jagan Mohan Reddy as Production No.2 under the Arrow Cinemas banner.

The film is all set to hit the global screens on October 30 and the makers hope it will provide the viewers with an entertaining experience.

Chakkora - Lunar Love Bird: Shiva Nirvana lauds team's sincerity at pre-release event

Star director Shiva Nirvana appreciated the sincerity and dedication of the team behind the film Chakkora - Lunar Love Bird at the pre-release event in Visakhapatnam. The mass poetry musical love story is all set to release globally on October 9. The film directed by veteran assistant director and debutant director Manga Srinivas stars Sravan and Malaika T. Vasupal in the lead roles. Dr. Chintada Hemarao is producing the film under the banner of High Joy Commercial, with the support of VIP - Vintage Iconic Pictures. Sri Lakshmi Pictures is distributing the film globally. Shiva Nirvana commended the young talents from Vizag and urged them to bring more such innovative films, appreciating the

performances, music, cinematography and the sincere efforts put in by the technical crew. He wished the film a great success. Director Manga Srinivas said that Chakkora is a love story between mother and son, friends and lovers set to music.

The film also talks about the wait for pure love and about chasing dreams with the tenacity of a Chakkora bird. They have completed the entire shoot in 45 days, said the Director. The DOP Ruppa G Krishna said that the cast and crew had great confidence about the film's entertainment quotient and the message it delivers. The cast and crew were unanimous in saying that the film is an enriching experience for the audience.



'Matsya' glimpse crosses 15 Million views; boosts buzz

Vivasvaan, the young hero, makes his debut in the Bollywood film industry with the folklore adventure film "Matsya". This upcoming film has been garnering lots of interest among the movie lovers. Directed by Ravi Goli and Teja Kanakala, the film has been produced by Samhitha Ganapathi Inturi under the G.B.R. Production.

The recent glimpse of the film Matsya, which has crossed 15 million views, has gained lots of attention. The view count of the video is increasing rapidly, creating high expectations about the film among the viewers.

With folkloresque adventure, the film promises to give an astonishing visual spectacle to the viewers. The glimpse video has gathered lots of attention due to its beautiful visual effects and unique concept. This film has created a unique impression on the viewers after the release of its first glimpse. It has been generating lots of interest, especially for being the debut film of Vivasvaan.

